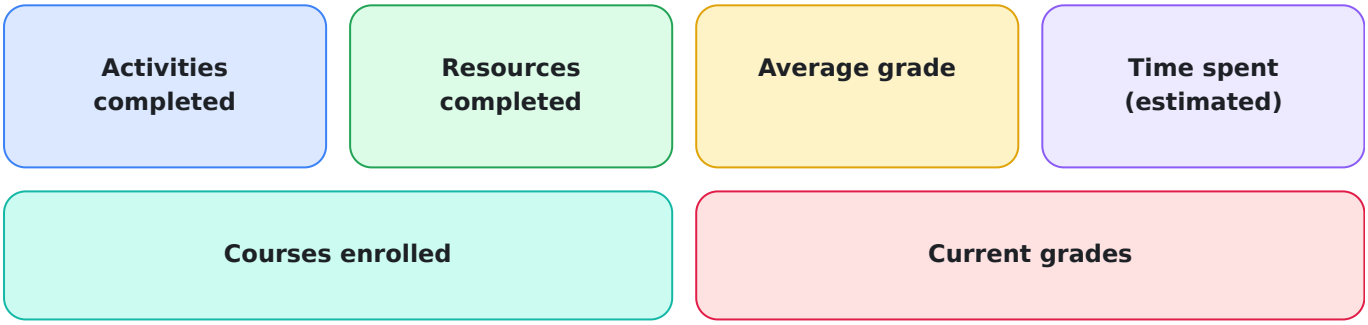
Moodle plugin walk-through

Student Summary Report

report_studentsummary release 0.4.1 · beta version 2026102500

A one-page, printable A4 summary of a student's engagement: completed activities and resources, average grade, estimated time spent, enrolled courses and current course grades.



Walk-through site	Fresh **Moodle 5.1.8+** site (build 20261021, branch `MOODLE_501_STABLE`), PHP 8.4.26, MariaDB 11.8.6. Plugin files identical to `report_studentsummary_2026102500.zip`, placed in `public/report/studentsummary`
Date	24 October 2026 (updated for release 0.4.1 on 25 October 2026)
Screenshots	27, taken with headless Chrome as an administrator, a teacher and two students (steps 23 to 27 are new in 0.4.0; step 1 was retaken for 0.4.1)
Source	Plugin development repository `/home/bill/test2/report_studentsummary`; build log in `docs/BUILD_LOG.md`

The demo site

The site was installed from scratch on Moodle 5.1 and populated with test data, so every screen in this document shows real plugin output. The same data set was used for the earlier Moodle 4.5 walk-through, so the numbers can be compared.

User	Role	Enrolments / purpose
Admin User	Site administrator	Sees everything; no enrolments
Tessa Teacher	Teacher	Teaches Biology, History, Algebra, Writing and 14 electives. Does **not** teach Chemistry or the hidden staff course
Alice Anderson	Student	Six courses (Biology, History, Algebra, Writing, Chemistry, hidden staff course); most completion and grades; 22 logged sessions
Ben Brown	Student	Biology and History; little completed work, one low grade
Chloe Chen	Student	No courses (empty state)
Dan Diaz	Student	Chemistry only (a course Tessa does not teach)
Maya Many	Student	14 elective courses (shows the “+N more” cap)

Two course settings matter for the walk-through: **Creative Writing** has “Show gradebook to students” switched off, and **Staff Moderation** is a hidden course.

Contents

Step	Screen
1	Plugin installed
2	Site administration > Reports
3	Admin settings
4	Setting validation (0.2.1)
5	Choosing colours (0.3.0)
6	Colour contrast check (0.3.0)
7	Link on the user profile
8	Report: administrator view of a student
9	Palette: Earth tones (0.3.0)
10	Many courses: the "+N more" cap
11	Empty state (no courses)
12	Teacher: link on the student's profile
13	Teacher: student in my courses
14	Date range filter
15	Teacher: another student
16	Access denied: student outside my courses
17	Own report
18	Student: link on own profile
19	Student: own report
20	Access denied: another student
21	Print button
22	Student with no courses
23	Course reports page: Student summaries (0.4.0)
24	All students of a course (0.4.0)
25	Choosing who to print (0.4.0)
26	Printing the whole class (0.4.0)
27	Printing a selection (0.4.0)
–	All palettes side by side
–	The printed A4 page
–	Summary

Installing on Moodle 5.1

Moodle 5.1 moved the web root to `public/`. The release zip contains a single top-level folder, `studentsummary/`, which goes into `public/report/` (on Moodle 4.5 it goes into `report/`). The walk-through site was installed with the plugin already in place, so the installer registered it; on an existing site the same folder is unpacked and `php admin/cli/upgrade.php` is run.

```
$ git clone --depth 1 -b MOODLE_501_STABLE https://github.com/moodle/moodle.git moodle51
$ unzip report_studentsummary_2026102500.zip -d moodle51/public/report/    (files identical to the
repo copy)
$ php public/admin/cli/install_database.php --agree-license ...
-->report_studentsummary
++ Success ++
Installation completed successfully.

$ php admin/cli/cfg.php --component=report_studentsummary
idletimeout  1200   maxcourses  12   palette  default
showtime     1      tailtime    60   version  2026102500
$ php admin/cli/cfg.php --name=release
5.1.8+ (Build: 20261021)
```

Capabilities registered

Capability	Context	Default roles	Meaning
`report/studentsummary:viewown`	System	Authenticated user	View your own report
`report/studentsummary:viewall`	Course	Teacher, Non-editing teacher, Manager	View reports of users enrolled in the course (personal-data risk flag)

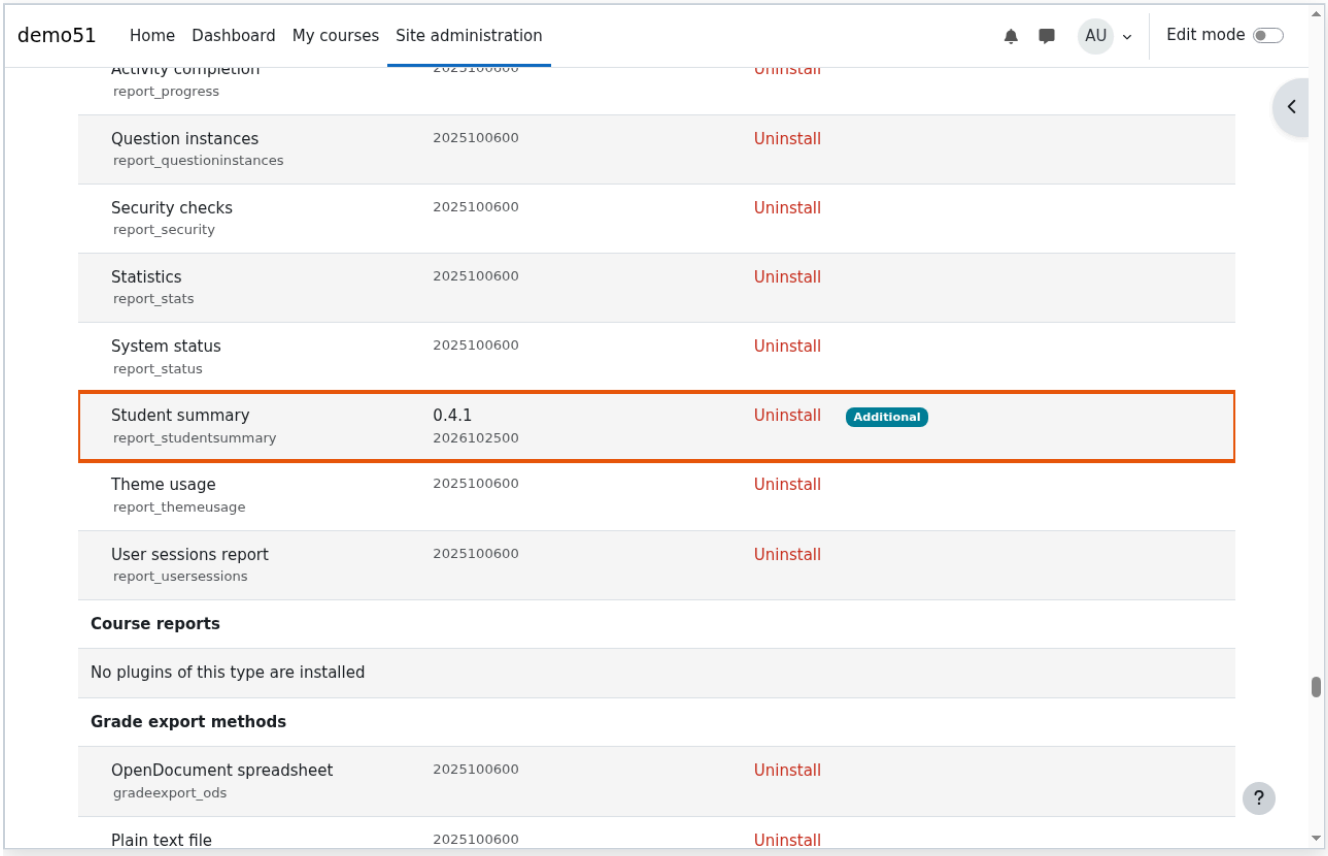
What a viewer is allowed to see

- Only courses where the viewer has **active** access to the course. A suspended teacher enrolment gives no access.
- In separate-groups courses, only students who share a group with the viewer (unless the viewer may access all groups).
- Grades only with `moodle/grade:viewall`; students see their own only if the course shows the gradebook to students.
- Time spent only for courses the viewer may see. The estimate is cached for 10 minutes in the viewer's own session.

1 Plugin installed

After the zip is unpacked into public/report/ and the site installed or upgraded, the plugin is listed under Site administration > Plugins > Plugins overview as "Student summary" (report_studentsummary), version 0.4.1 (beta), on Moodle 5.1.

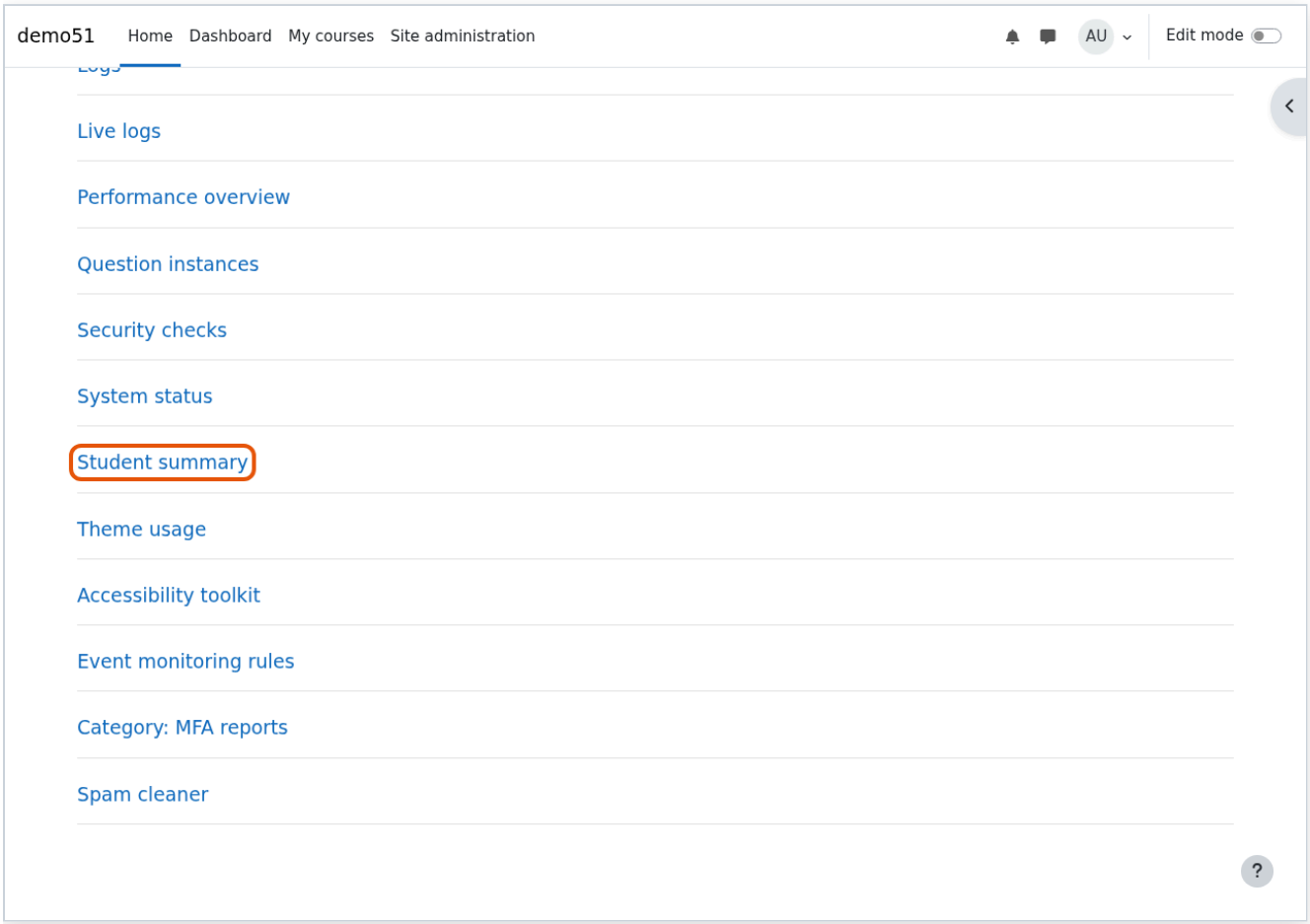
`/admin/plugins.php`



2 Site administration > Reports

The report is linked from Site administration > Reports. The link opens the administrator's own report.

`/admin/category.php?category=reports`



3 Admin settings

Site administration > Plugins > Reports > Student summary. Idle timeout and tail time drive the time estimate, "Maximum courses listed" (1 to 50) keeps the page on one A4 sheet, and "Show time spent" can switch the estimate off.

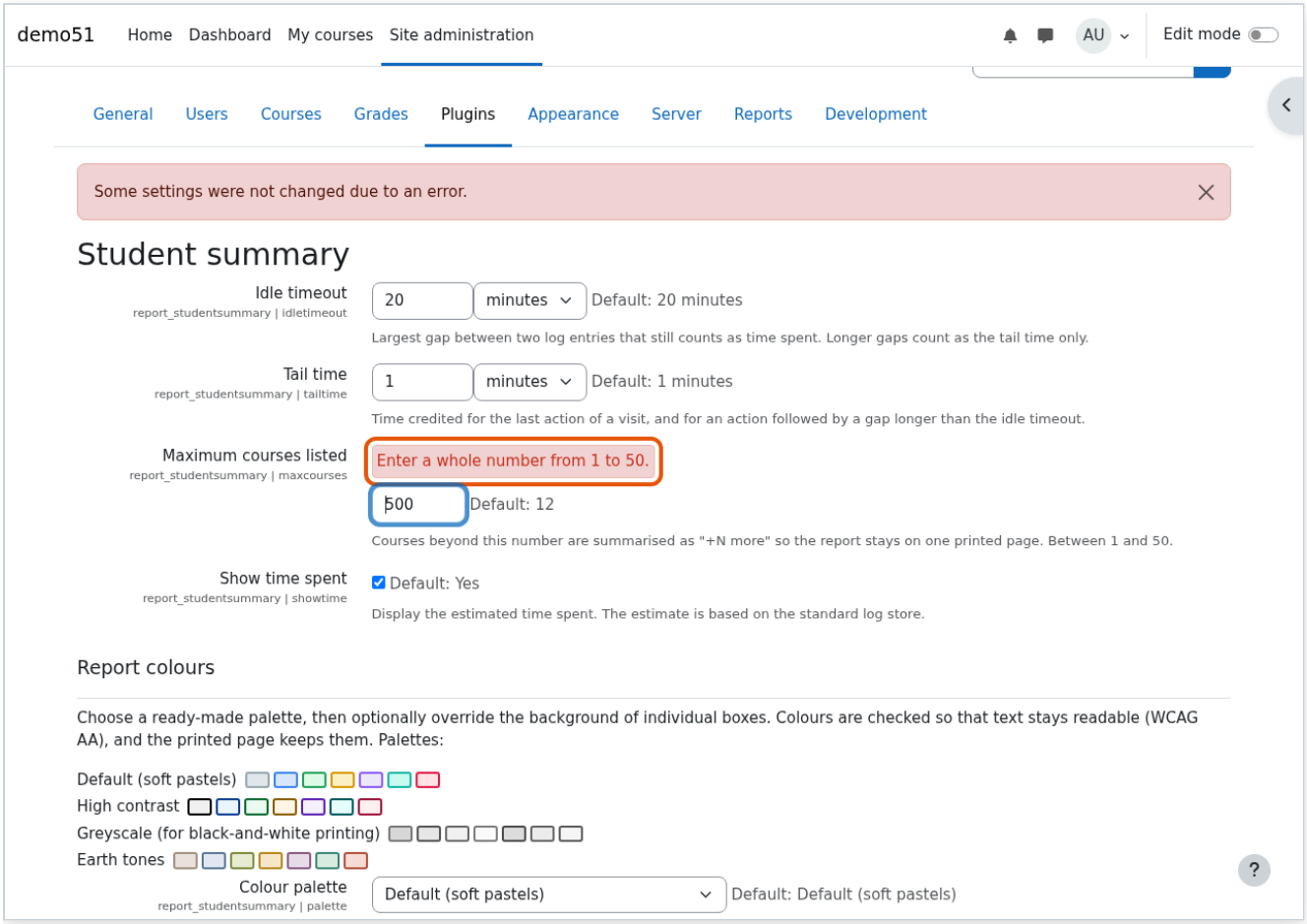
`/admin/settings.php?section=reportstudentsummary`



4 Setting validation (0.2.1)

New in 0.2.1: "Maximum courses listed" only accepts whole numbers from 1 to 50. Entering 500 and saving is refused with an error and nothing is stored. (The report also enforces the limit when it is built.)

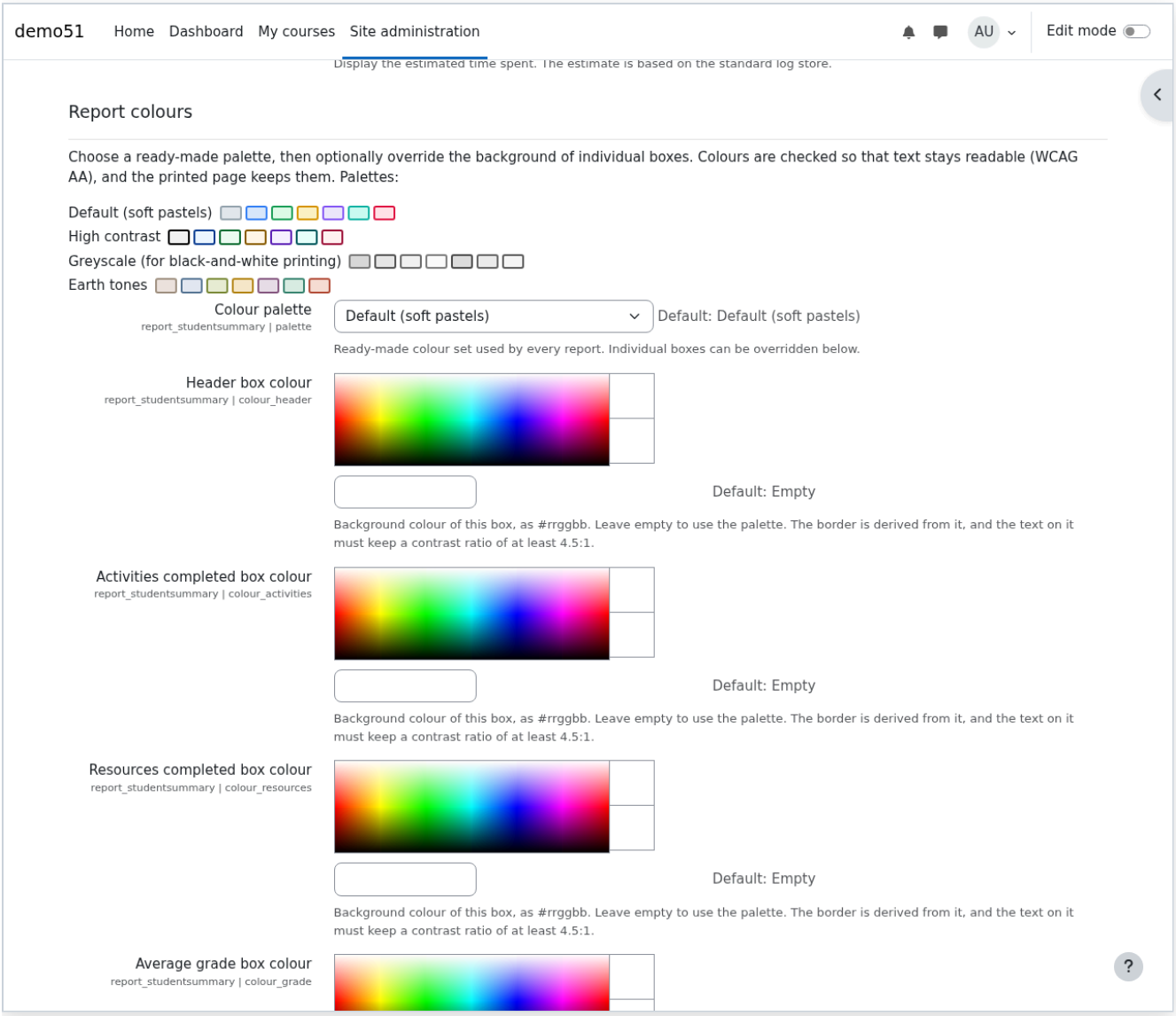
`/admin/settings.php?section=reportstudentsummary`



5 Choosing colours (0.3.0)

New in 0.3.0: the "Report colours" section. Pick a ready-made palette (swatches for each are shown), then optionally override the background of any single box with a colour. Leave a box empty to use the palette; its border is derived automatically.

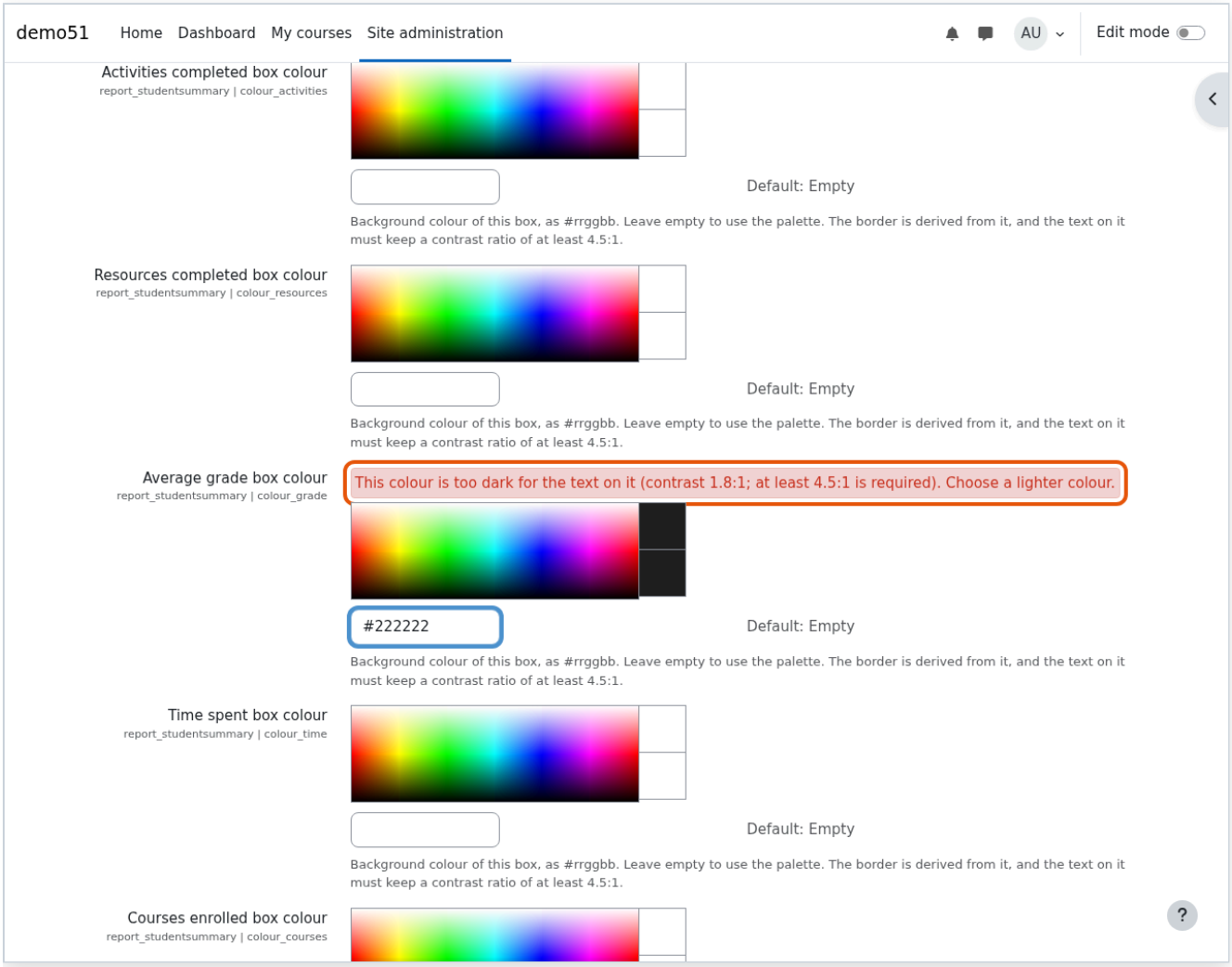
`/admin/settings.php?section=reportstudentsummary`



6 Colour contrast check (0.3.0)

A colour is only accepted if the text on it stays readable (contrast of at least 4.5:1, WCAG AA). A near-black background for the Average grade box is refused with an explanation, and nothing is stored. Anything that is not a #rrggbb colour is refused too.

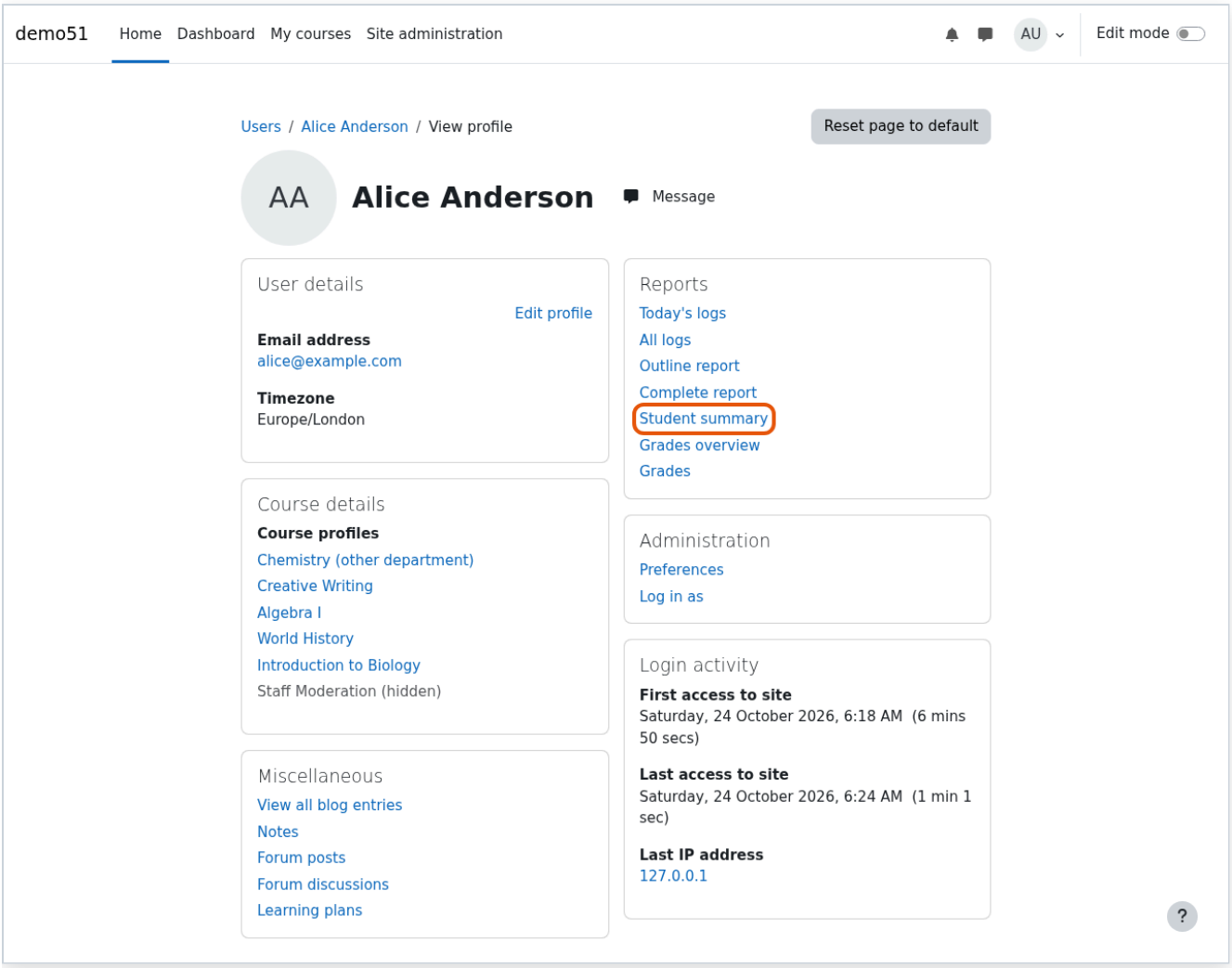
`/admin/settings.php?section=reportstudentsummary`



7 Link on the user profile

The report is also reachable from the Reports section of each user's profile. Only viewers allowed to see that user's report get the link.

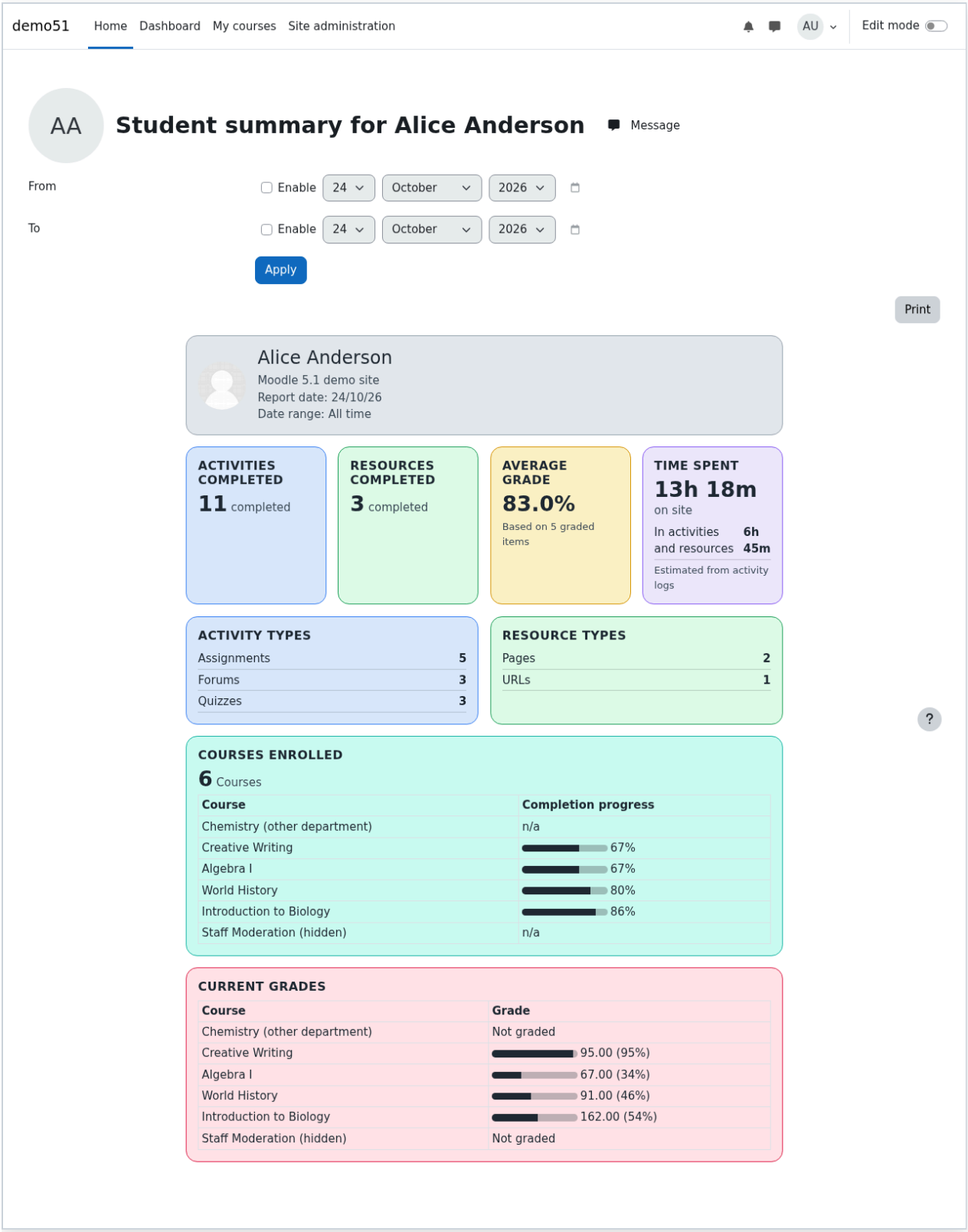
`/user/profile.php?id=4`



8 Report: administrator view of a student

Administrator viewing Alice Anderson. Seven colour-coded boxes: header, activities completed (blue), resources completed (green), average grade (amber), estimated time spent (purple), courses enrolled (teal) and current grades (rose). Administrators see every course, including the hidden one.

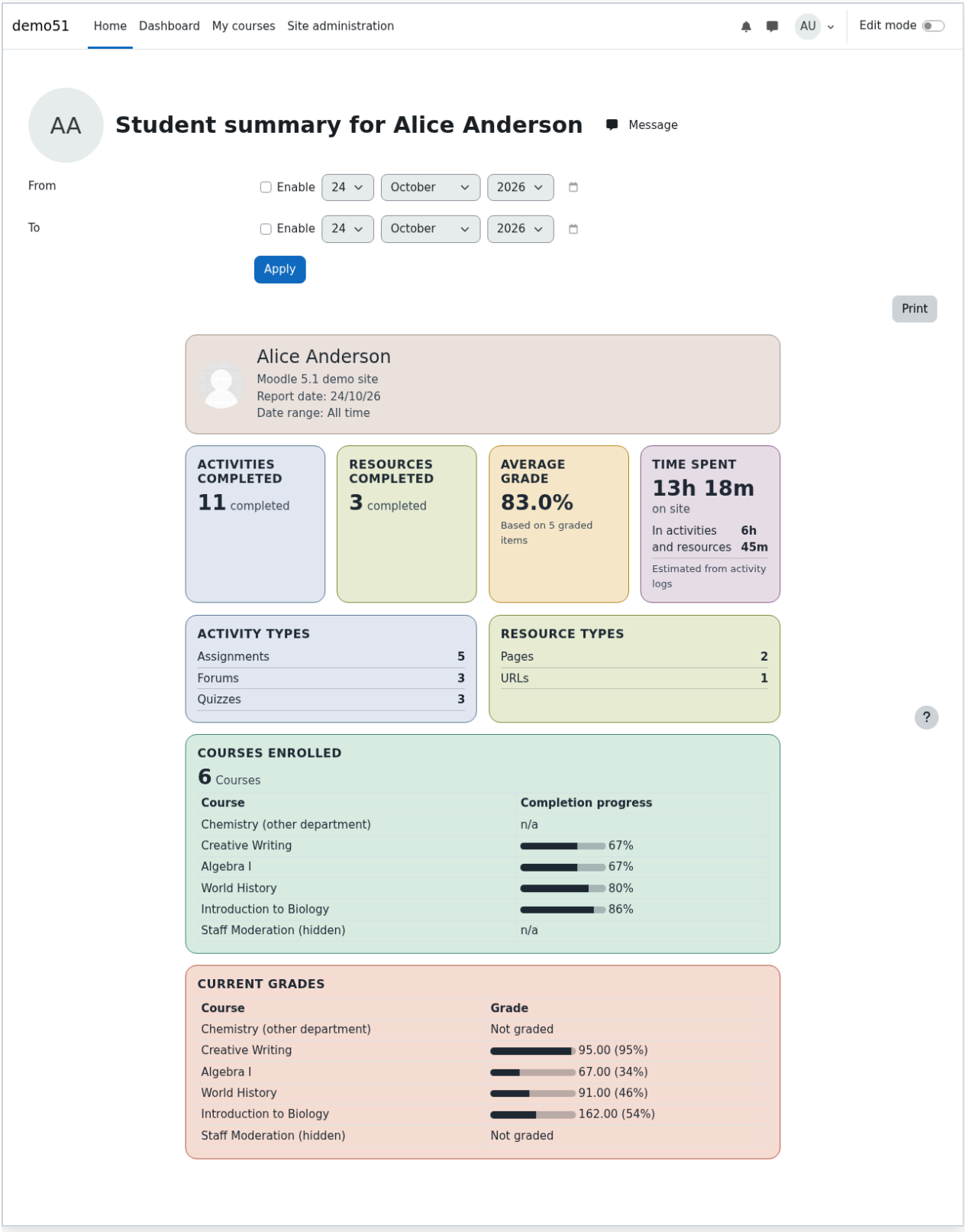
`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=4`



9 Palette: Earth tones (0.3.0)

The same report with the "Earth tones" palette chosen by the administrator. The colours are applied on screen and on the printed page; the headings still carry the meaning, so colour is never the only cue.

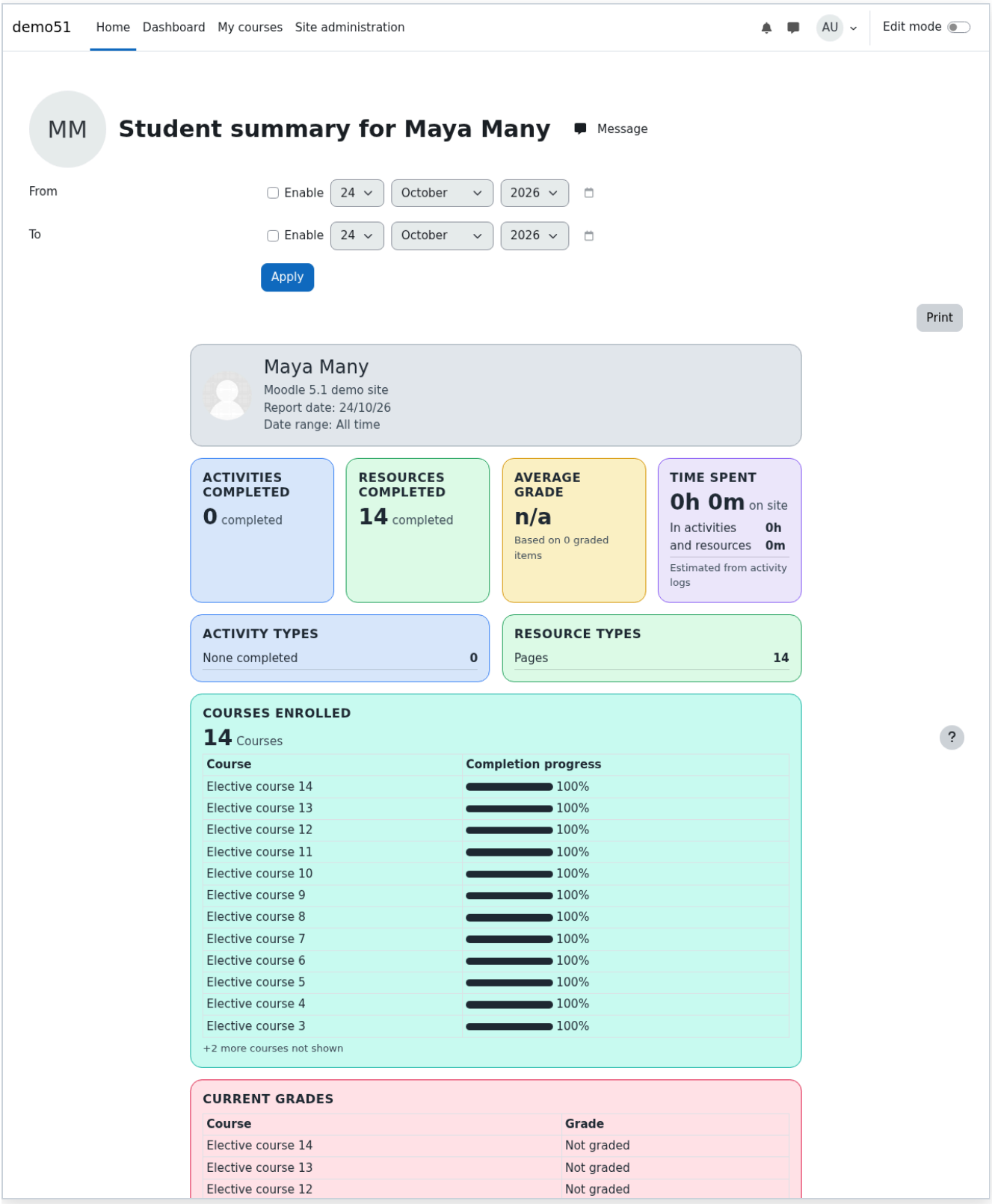
`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=4`



10 Many courses: the "+N more" cap

Maya Many is enrolled in 14 courses. The "Maximum courses listed" setting (12) keeps the page to one sheet: the remaining courses are summarised as "+2 more".

`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=8`



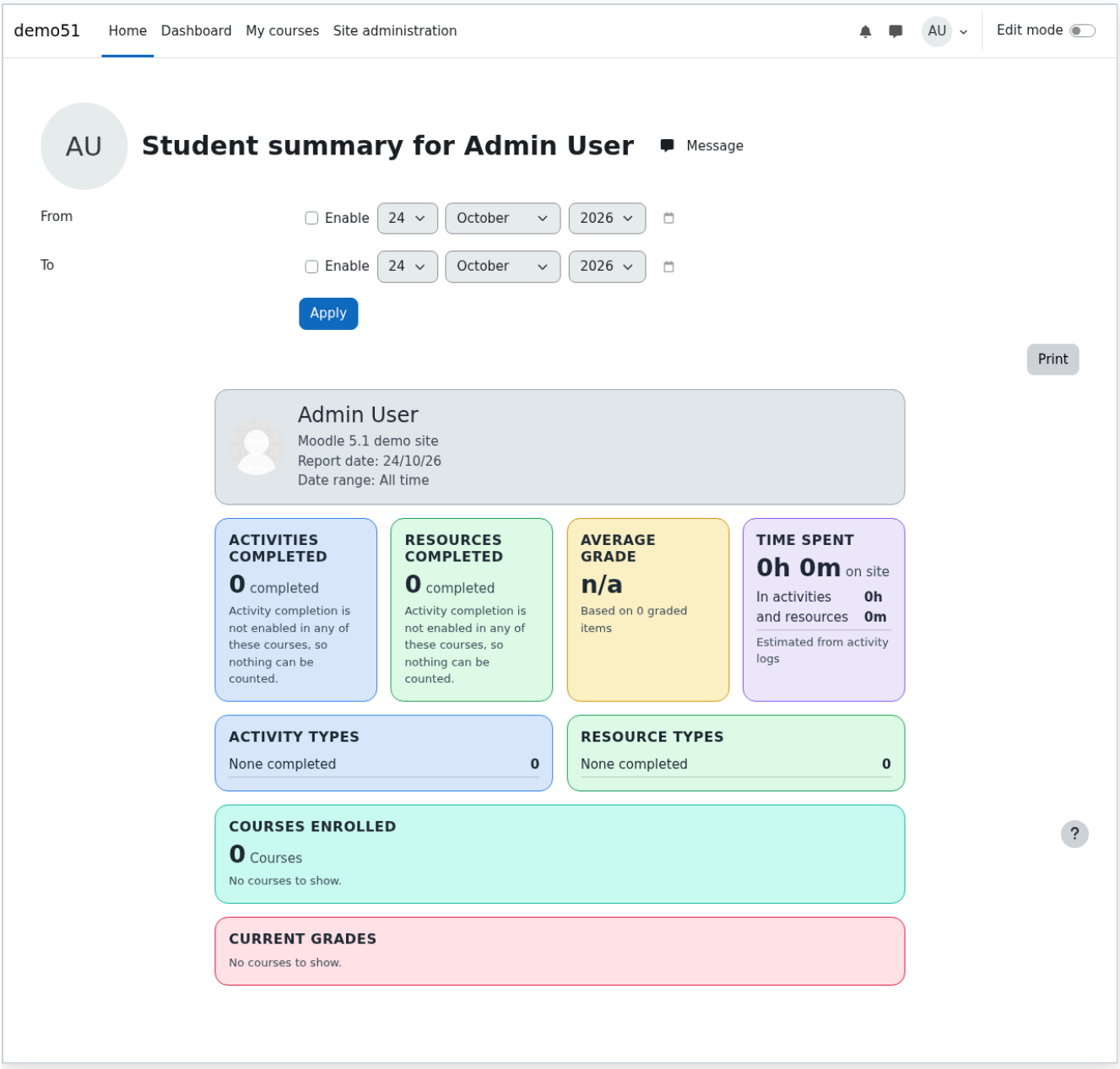
Step 10: Many courses: the "+N more" cap — continued

Elective course 11	Not graded
Elective course 10	Not graded
Elective course 9	Not graded
Elective course 8	Not graded
Elective course 7	Not graded
Elective course 6	Not graded
Elective course 5	Not graded
Elective course 4	Not graded
Elective course 3	Not graded

11 Empty state (no courses)

An administrator with no enrolments: the report shows an empty state rather than an error.

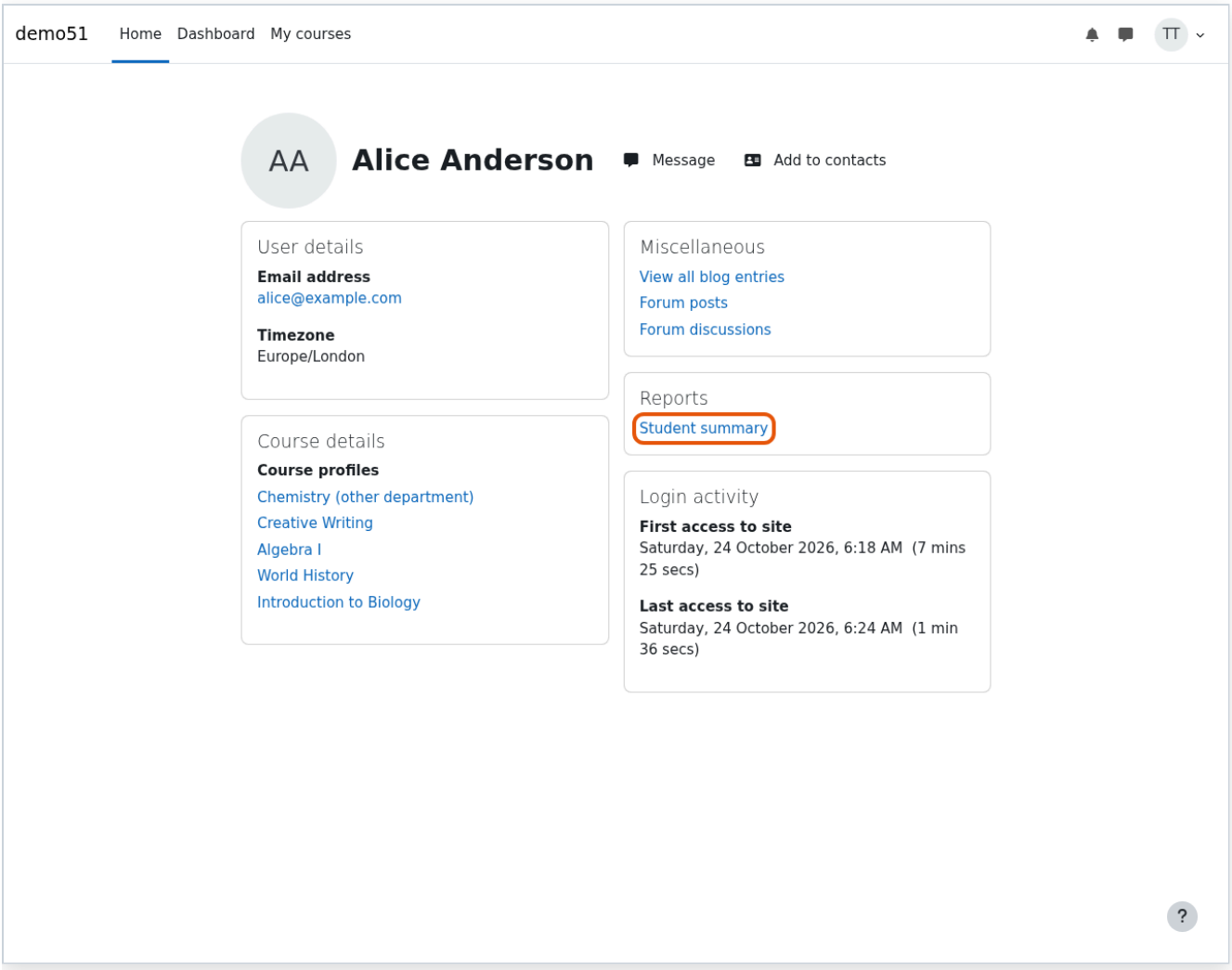
`/report/studentsummary/index.php`



12 Teacher: link on the student's profile

Tessa Teacher teaches four of Alice's courses. On Alice's profile, Reports > Student summary is offered.

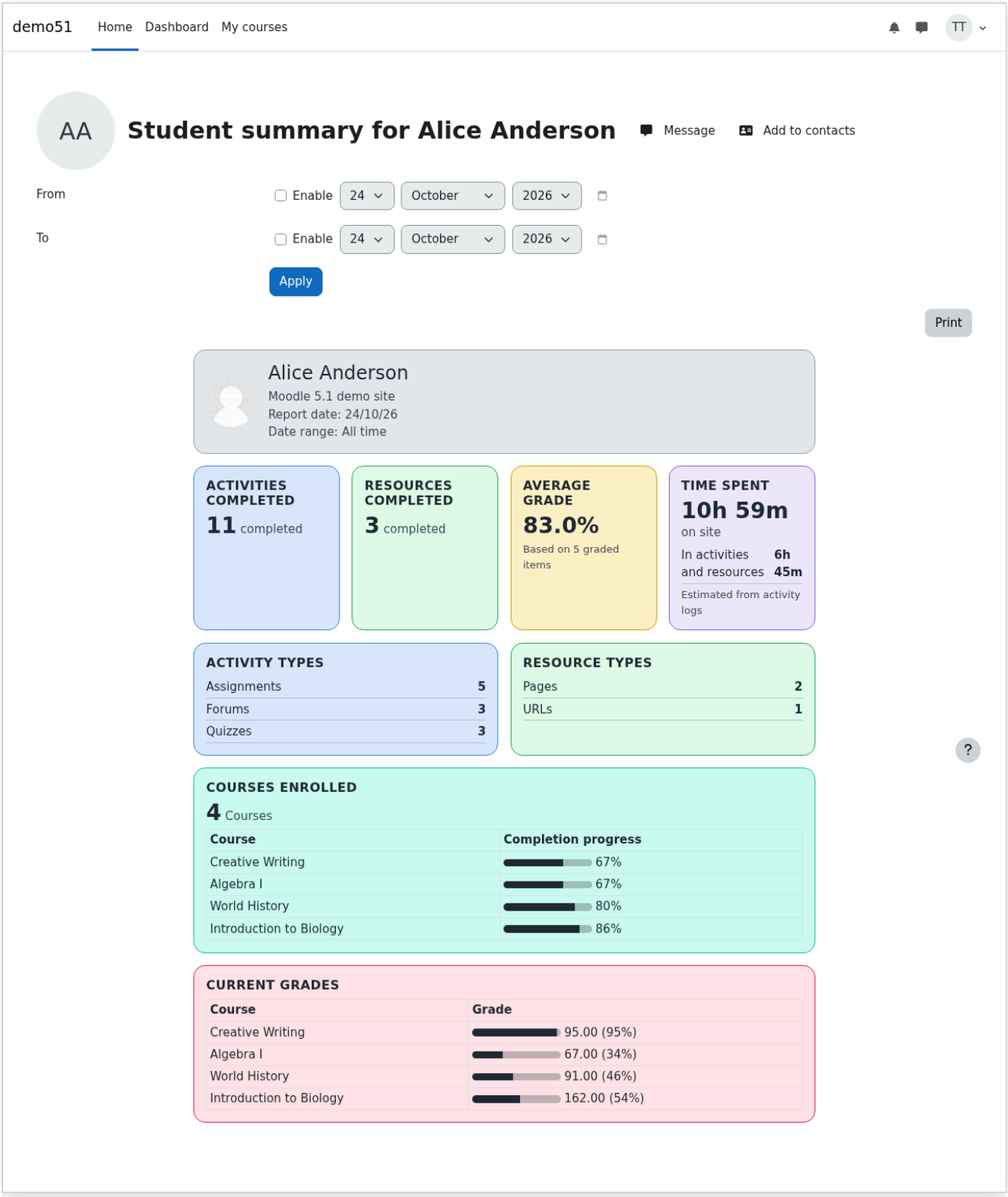
`/user/profile.php?id=4`



13 Teacher: student in my courses

The teacher's view of Alice. Only the four courses Tessa teaches are listed: Chemistry and the hidden staff course are left out, and time spent leaves out Alice's activity in courses Tessa cannot see. Creative Writing shows Alice's grade to the teacher even though the gradebook is hidden from students.

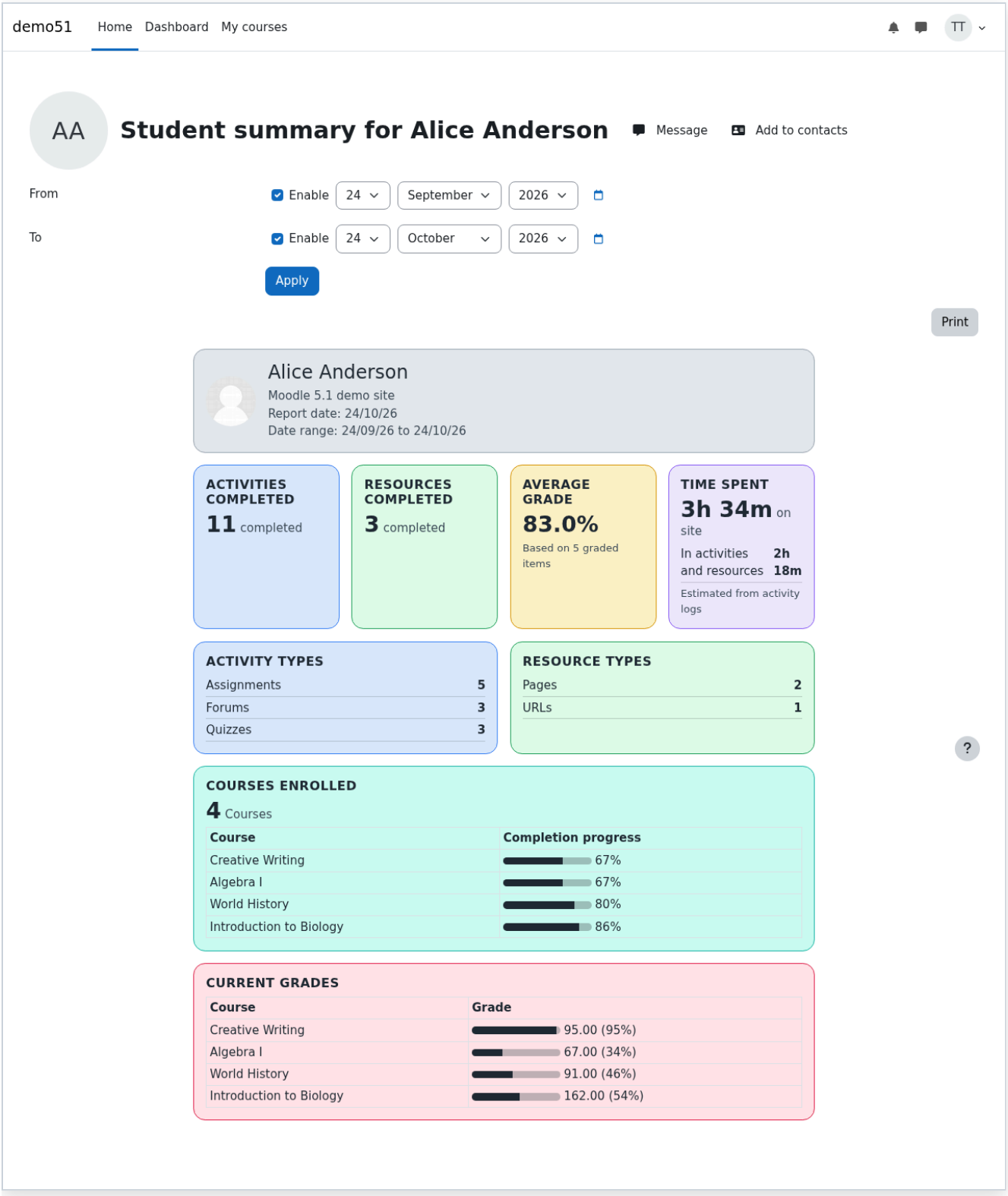
`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=4`



14 Date range filter

Using the From / To filter limits the time estimate to the last 30 days; completion and grades are always current. The chosen range is shown in the header.

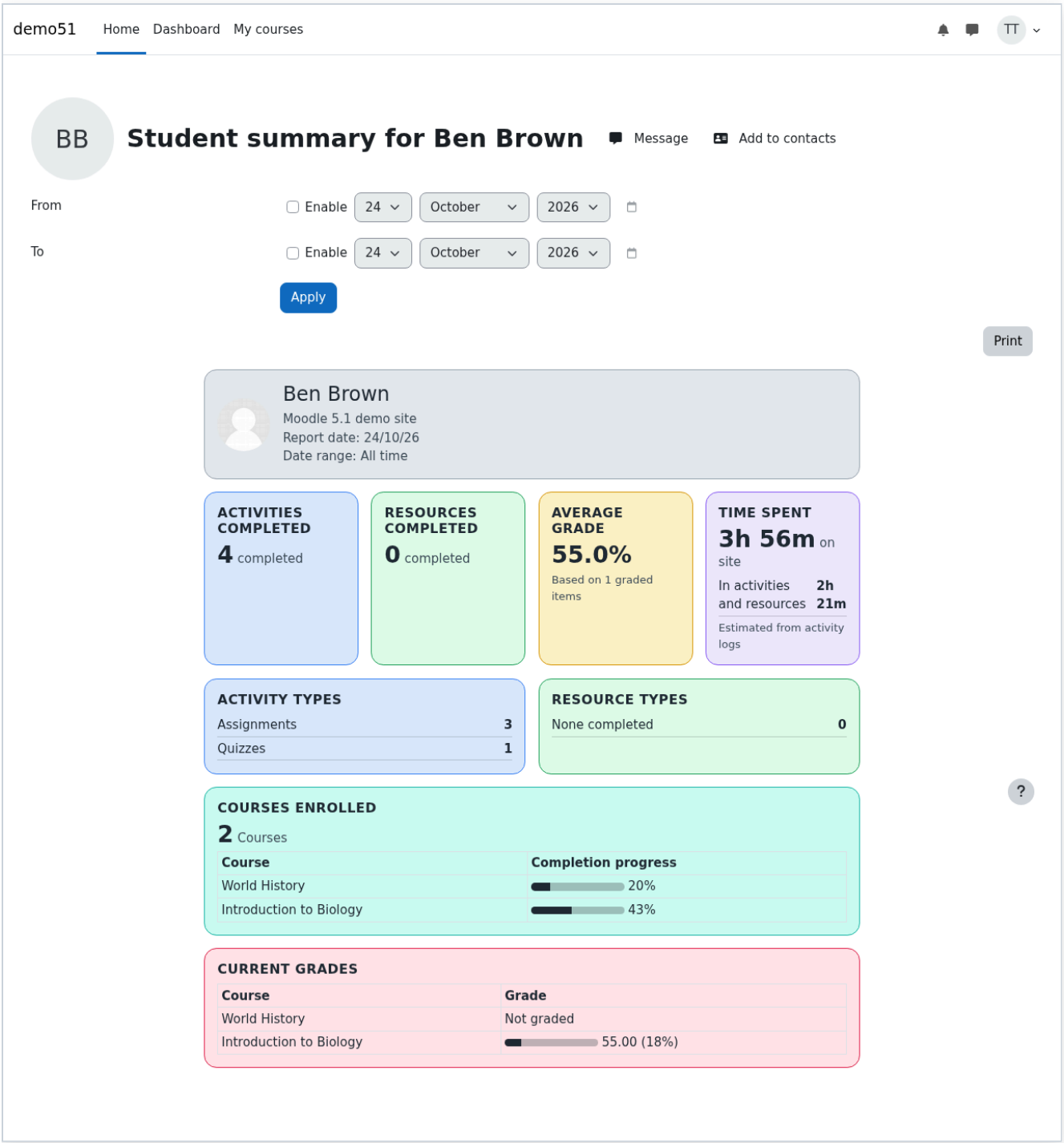
`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=4&userid=4&sesskey=SESSKEY&_qf__report_studentsummary_form_filter_form=1&from%5Benabled%5D=1&from%5Bday%5D=24&from%5Bmonth%5D=9&from%5Byear%5D=2026&to%5Benabled%5D=1&to%5Bday%5D=24&to%5Bmonth%5D=10&to%5Byear%5D=2026&submitbutton=Apply`



15 Teacher: another student

Ben Brown is in two of Tessa's courses. A student with little completed work and one low grade.

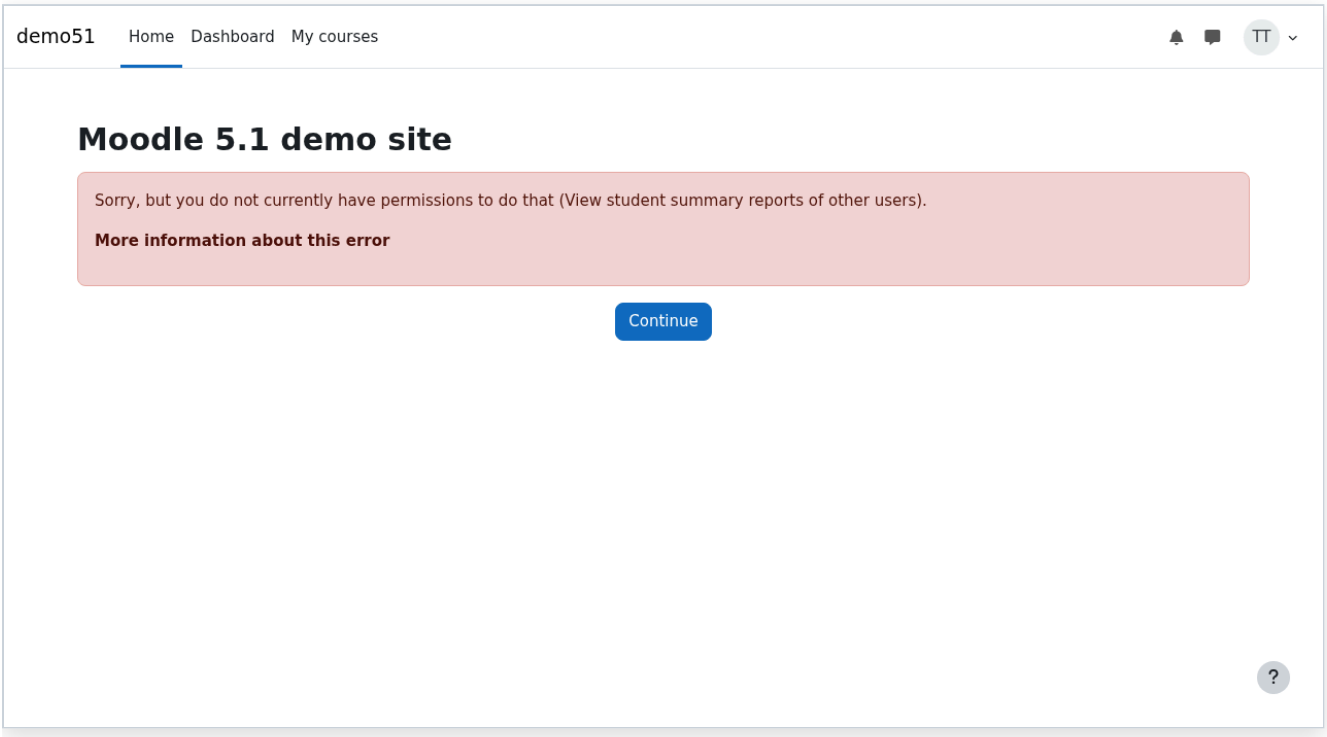
`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=5`



16 Access denied: student outside my courses

Dan Diaz is only enrolled in Chemistry, which Tessa does not teach. Changing the userid in the URL gives a permission error, not a report.

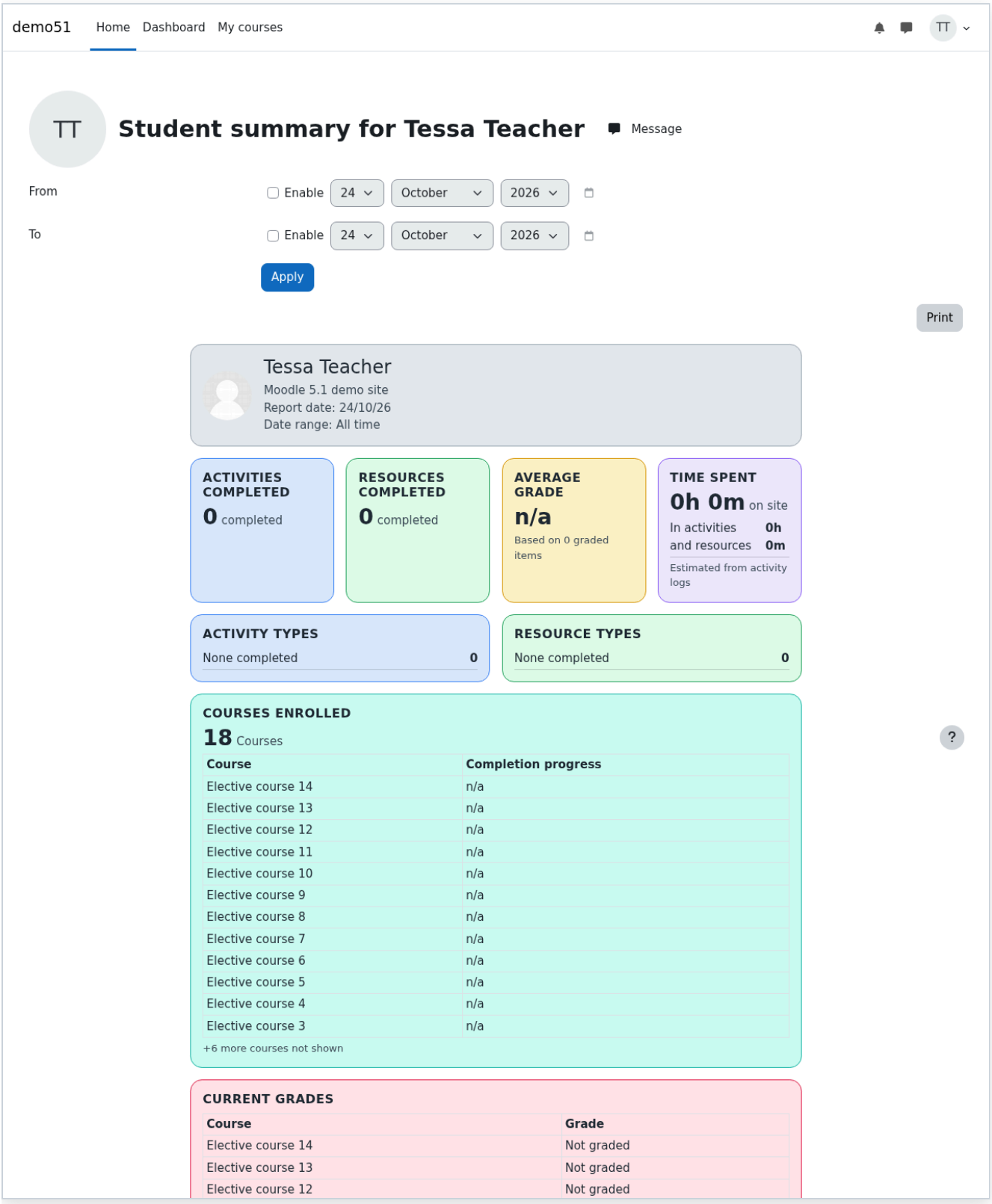
`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=7`



17 Own report

Everyone (role "Authenticated user") can view their own report. Tessa has no completion data of her own.

`/report/studentsummary/index.php`

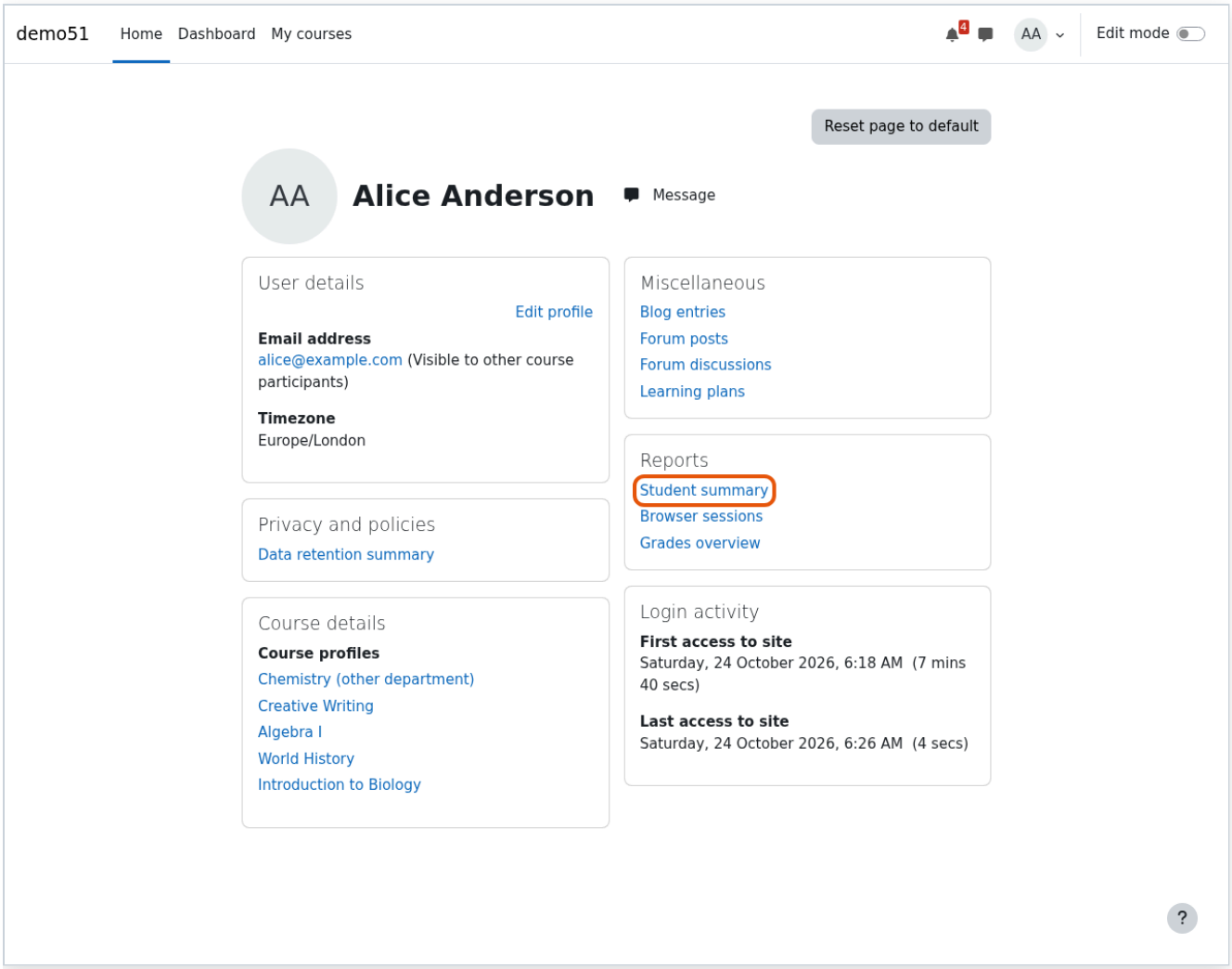


Elective course 11	Not graded
Elective course 10	Not graded
Elective course 9	Not graded
Elective course 8	Not graded
Elective course 7	Not graded
Elective course 6	Not graded
Elective course 5	Not graded
Elective course 4	Not graded
Elective course 3	Not graded

18 Student: link on own profile

Alice sees the Student summary link on her own profile.

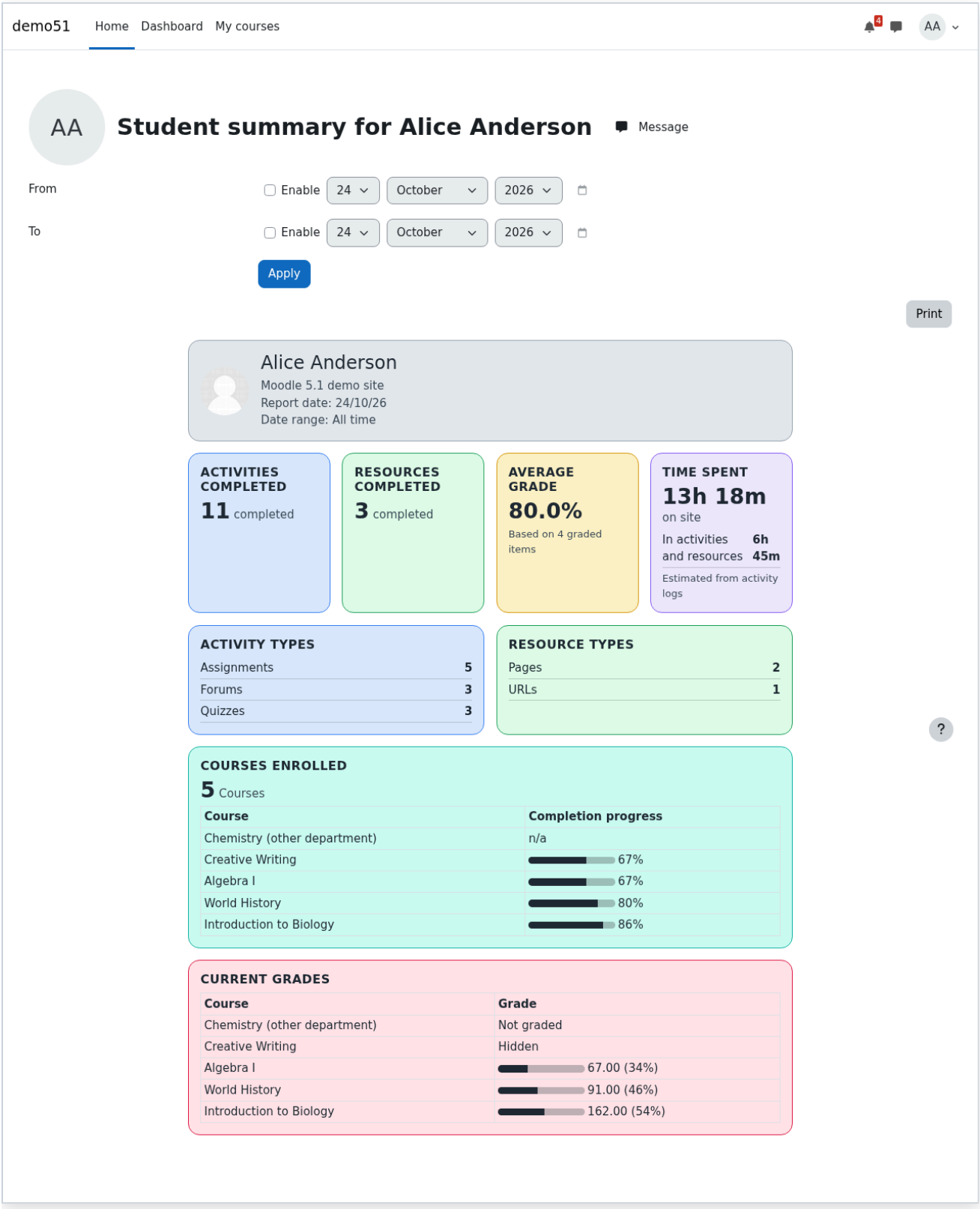
`/user/profile.php?id=4`



19 Student: own report

Alice's own report. The "Creative Writing" course has "Show gradebook to students" switched off, so its grade is shown as "Hidden" to Alice (the teacher saw the grade). Hidden courses and hidden grades never leak to students.

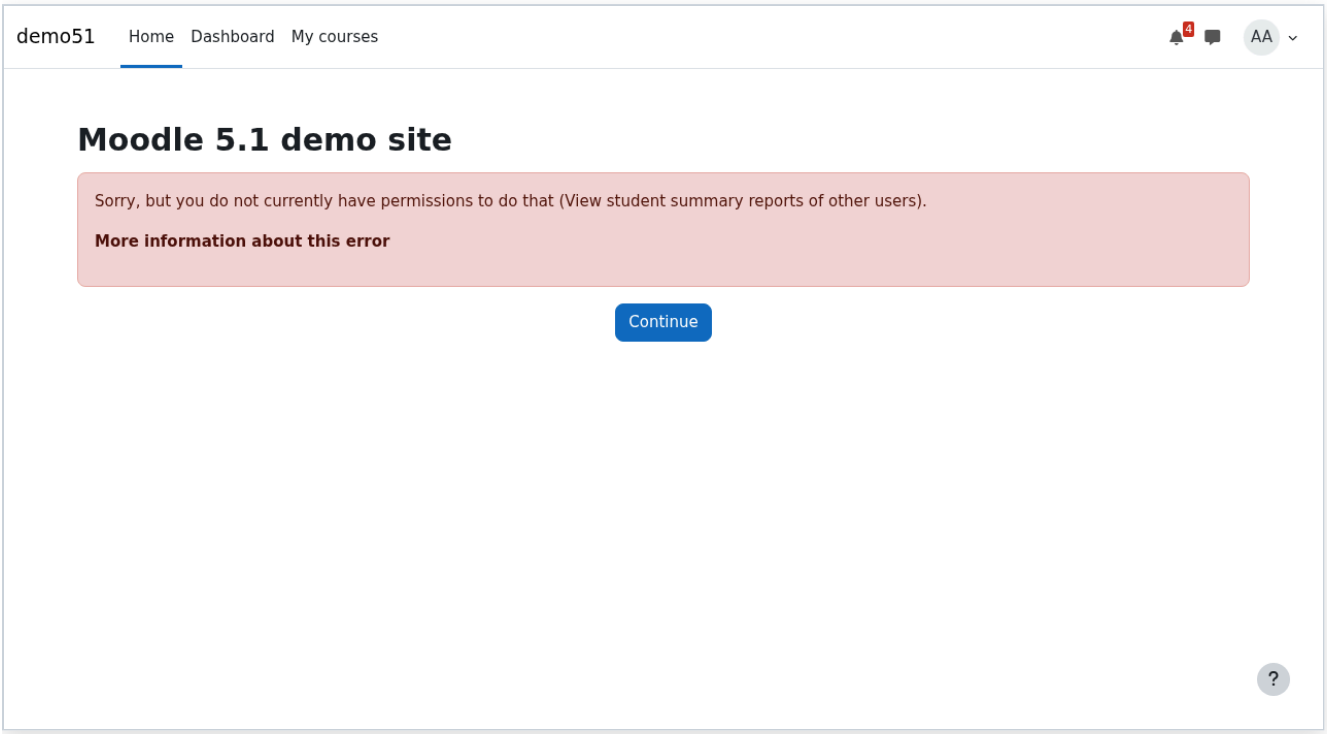
`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=4`



20 Access denied: another student

Alice tries to open Ben's report by editing the URL. A student may only view their own report.

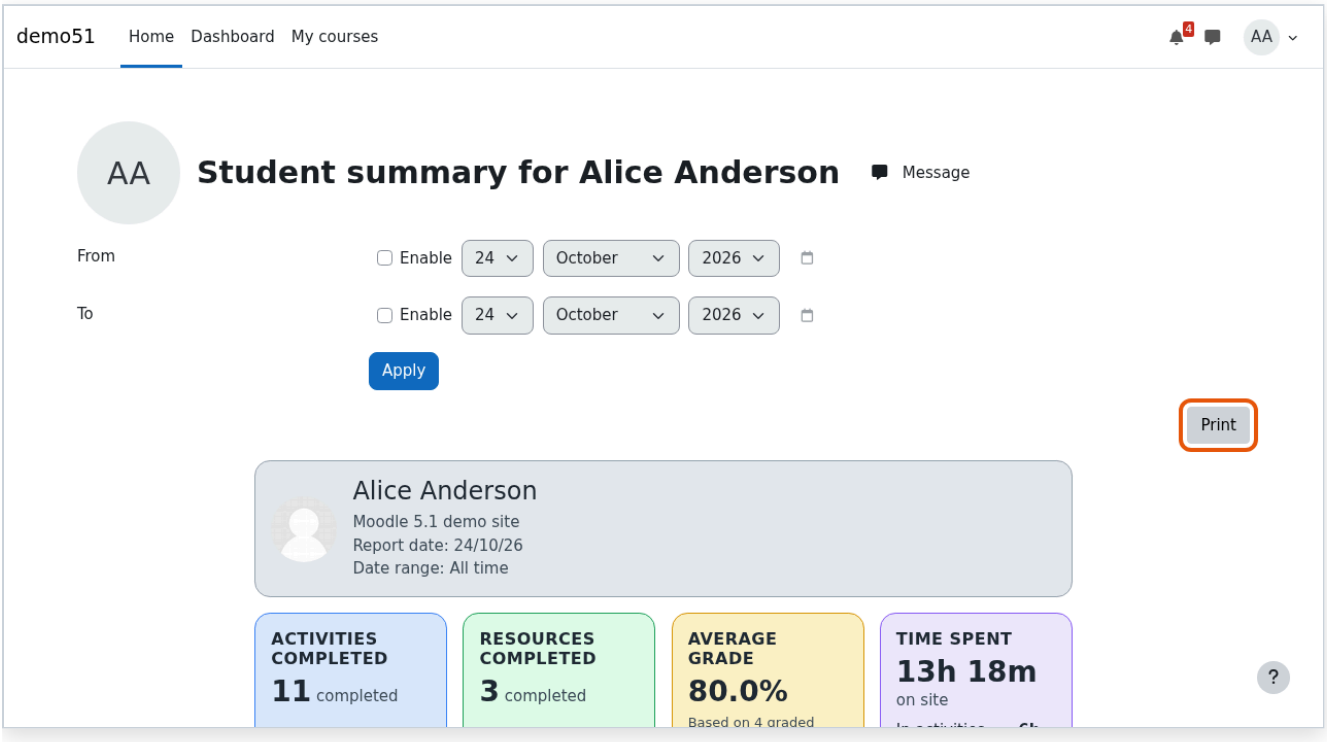
`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=5`



21 Print button

The Print button (top right) opens the browser print dialog. The filter form and button are hidden on paper.

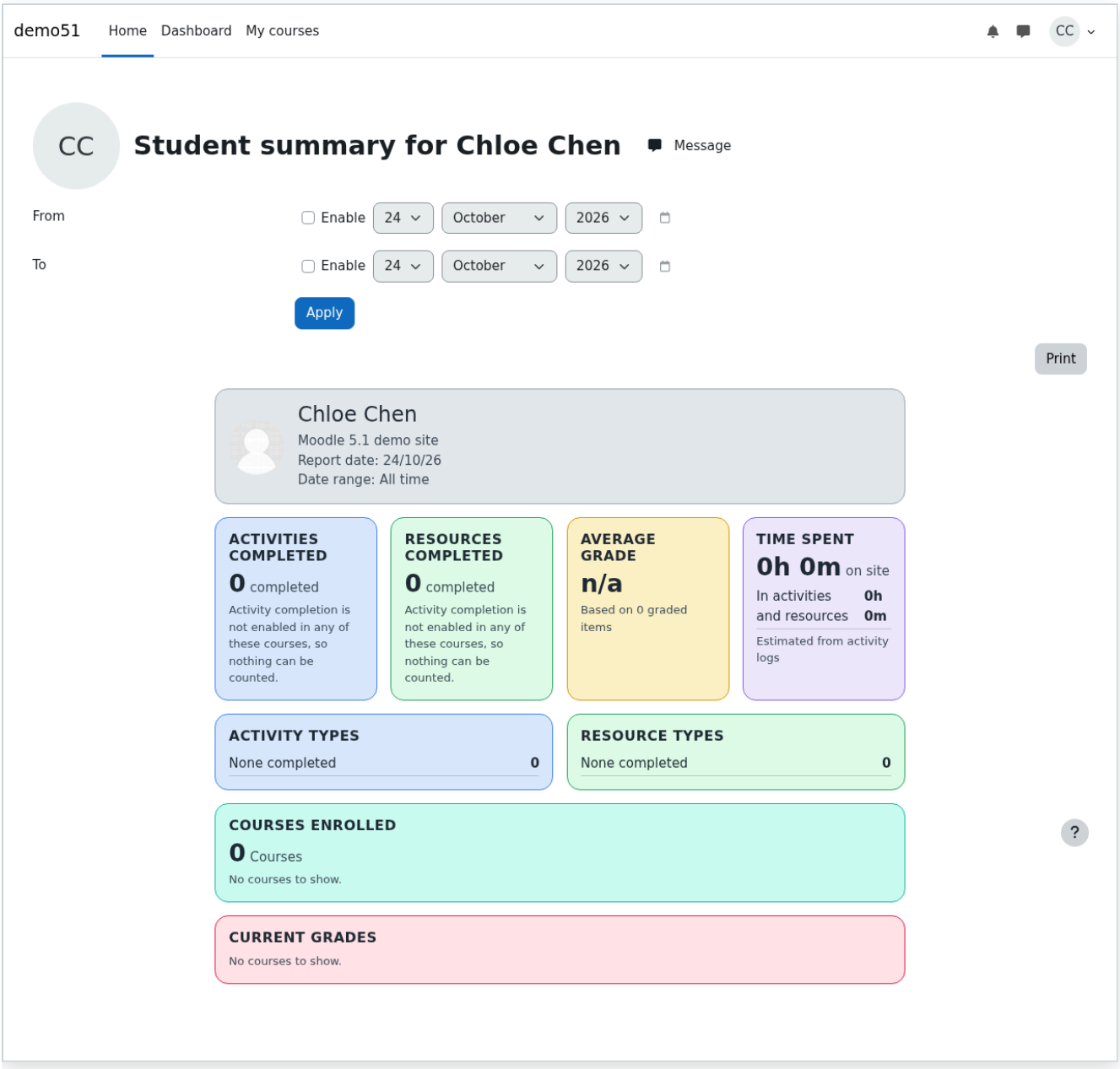
`/report/studentsummary/index.php?userid=4`



22 Student with no courses

A newly created student with no enrolments: every box shows zero or "n/a", with a friendly note instead of tables.

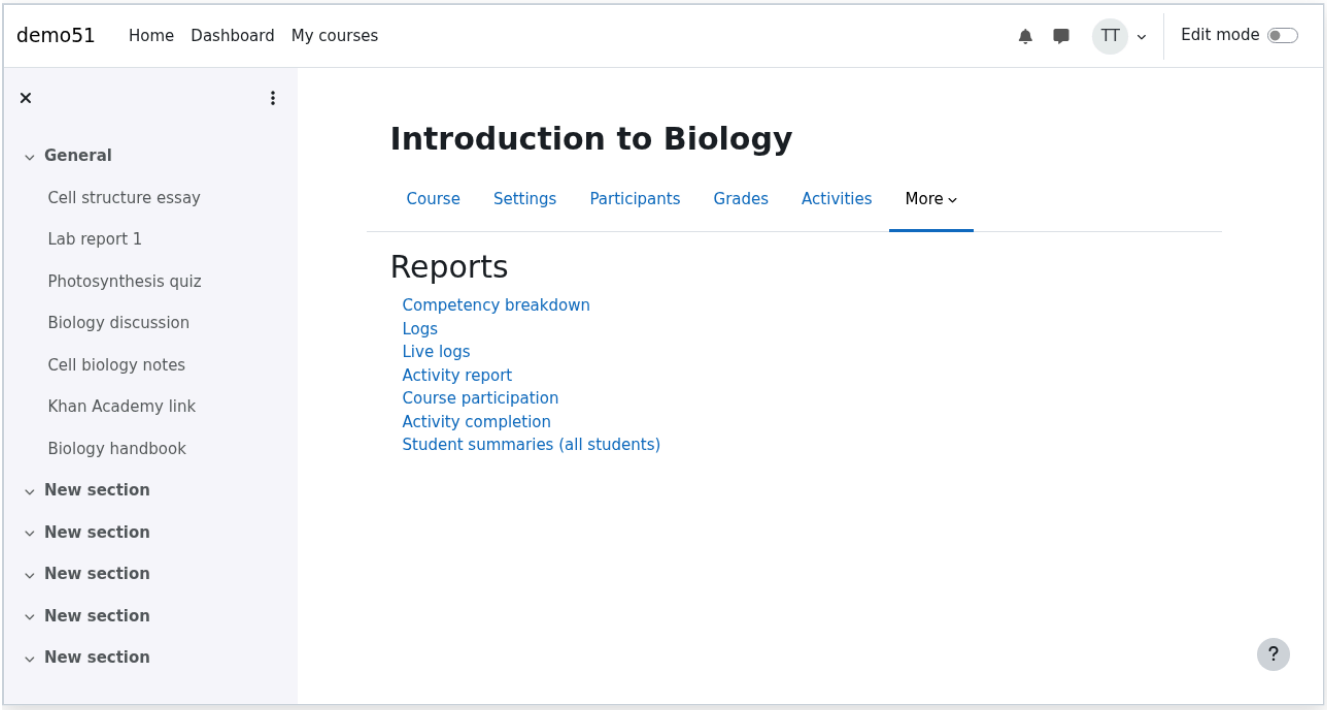
`/report/studentsummary/index.php`



23 Course reports page: Student summaries (0.4.0)

New in 0.4.0: teachers get a **Student summaries (all students)** link on the course Reports page (Course > More > Reports). It appears only for users who hold `report/studentsummary:viewall` in the course.

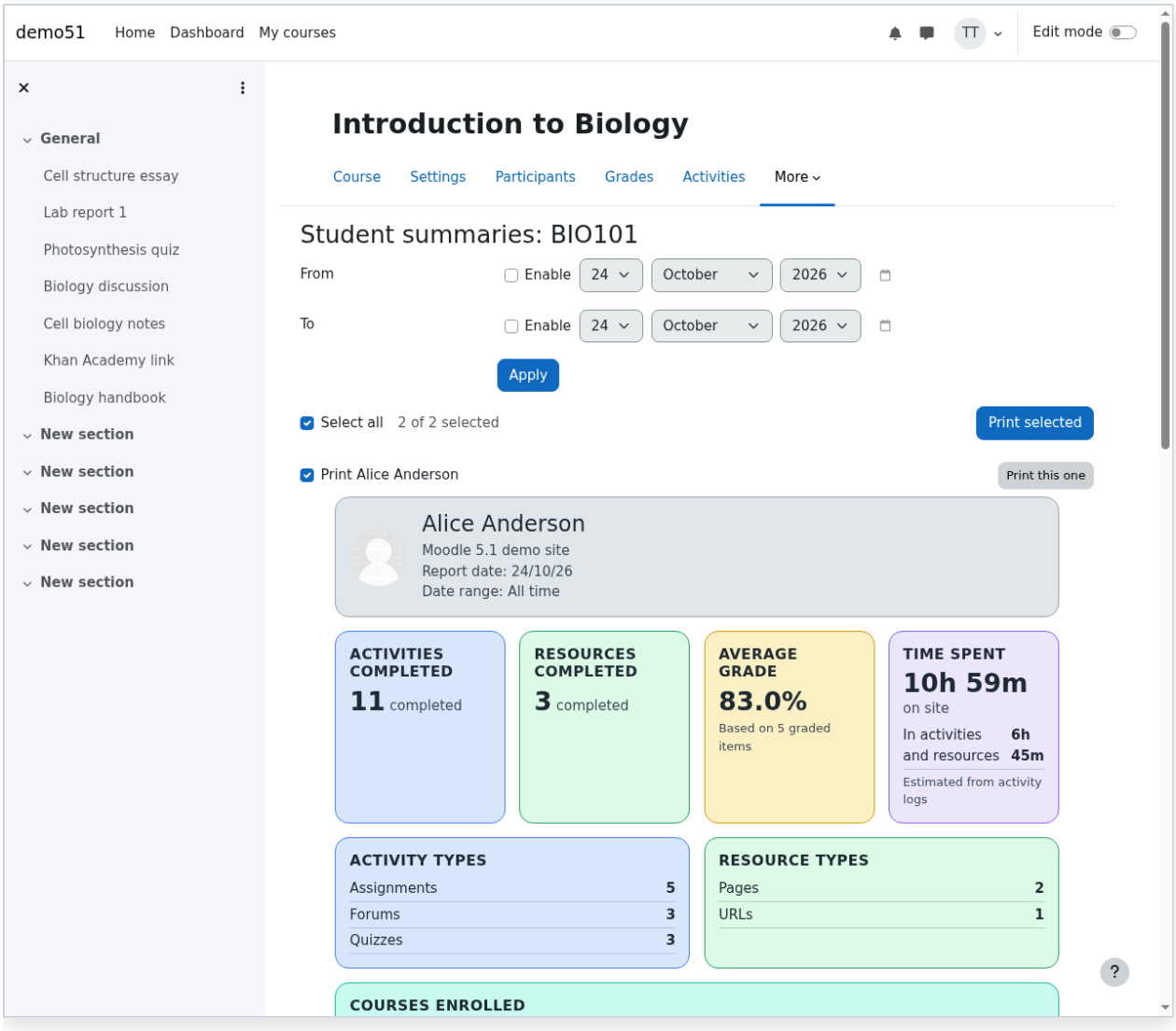
`/report/view.php?courseid=2`



24 All students of a course (0.4.0)

Tessa opens the page for Introduction to Biology. There is one summary for every active student (here Alice and Ben; teachers and suspended users are left out), in last-name order. Above them: a group menu in group courses, the same From / To filter (one range for the whole class), **Select all**, **Print selected**, and per student a tick box and **Print this one**. Alice's figures match her single report as seen by the teacher (11 activities, 3 resources, 83.0%, 10h 59m). More than 25 students are split over pages (10, 25, 50 or 100 per page).

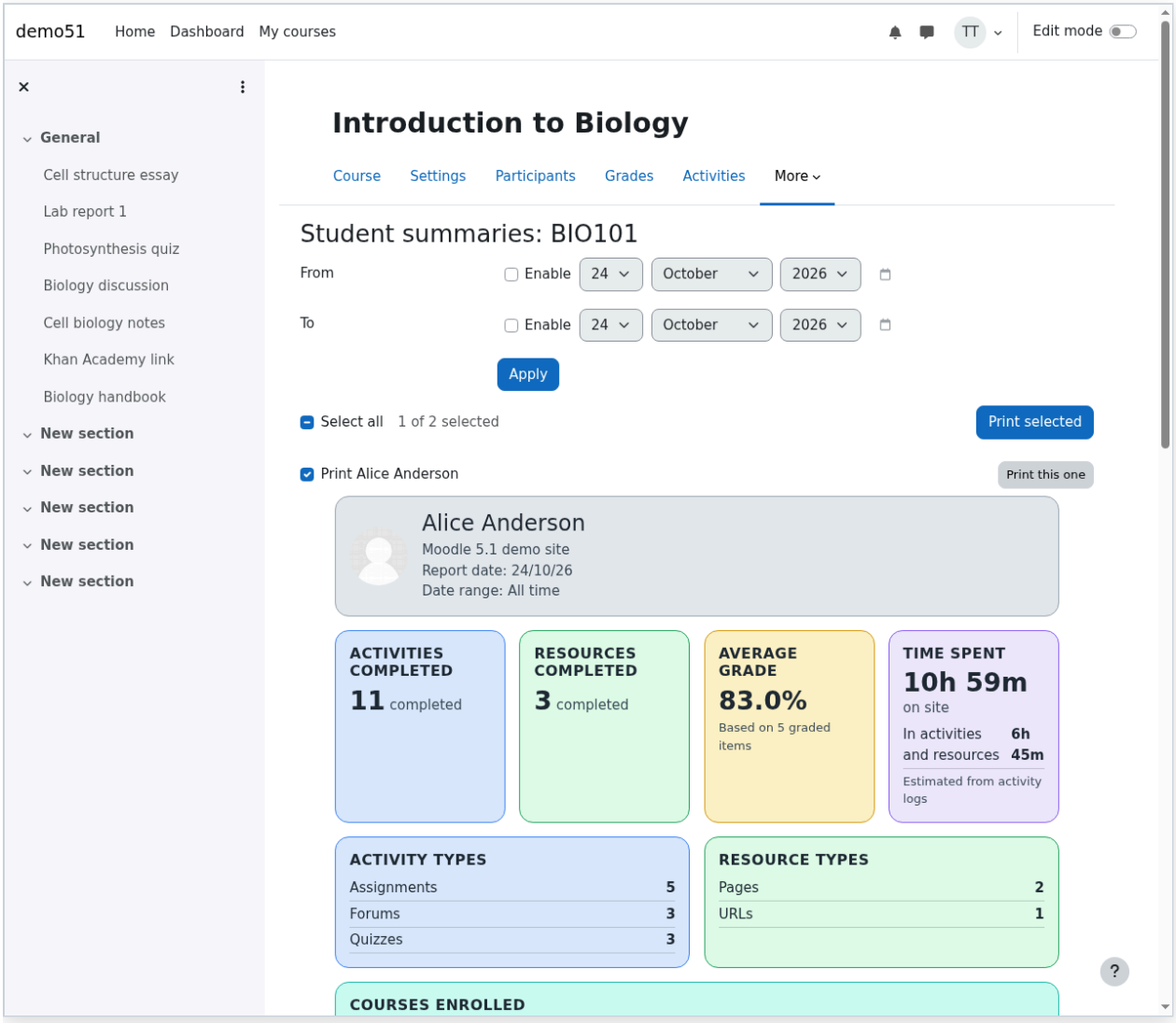
`/report/studentsummary/course.php?id=2`



25 Choosing who to print (0.4.0)

Un-ticking Ben Brown updates the count to “1 of 2 selected” and the Select all box shows a partial state. Un-ticked students are left out of the printout. Ben’s summary and his own tick box are further down the same page.

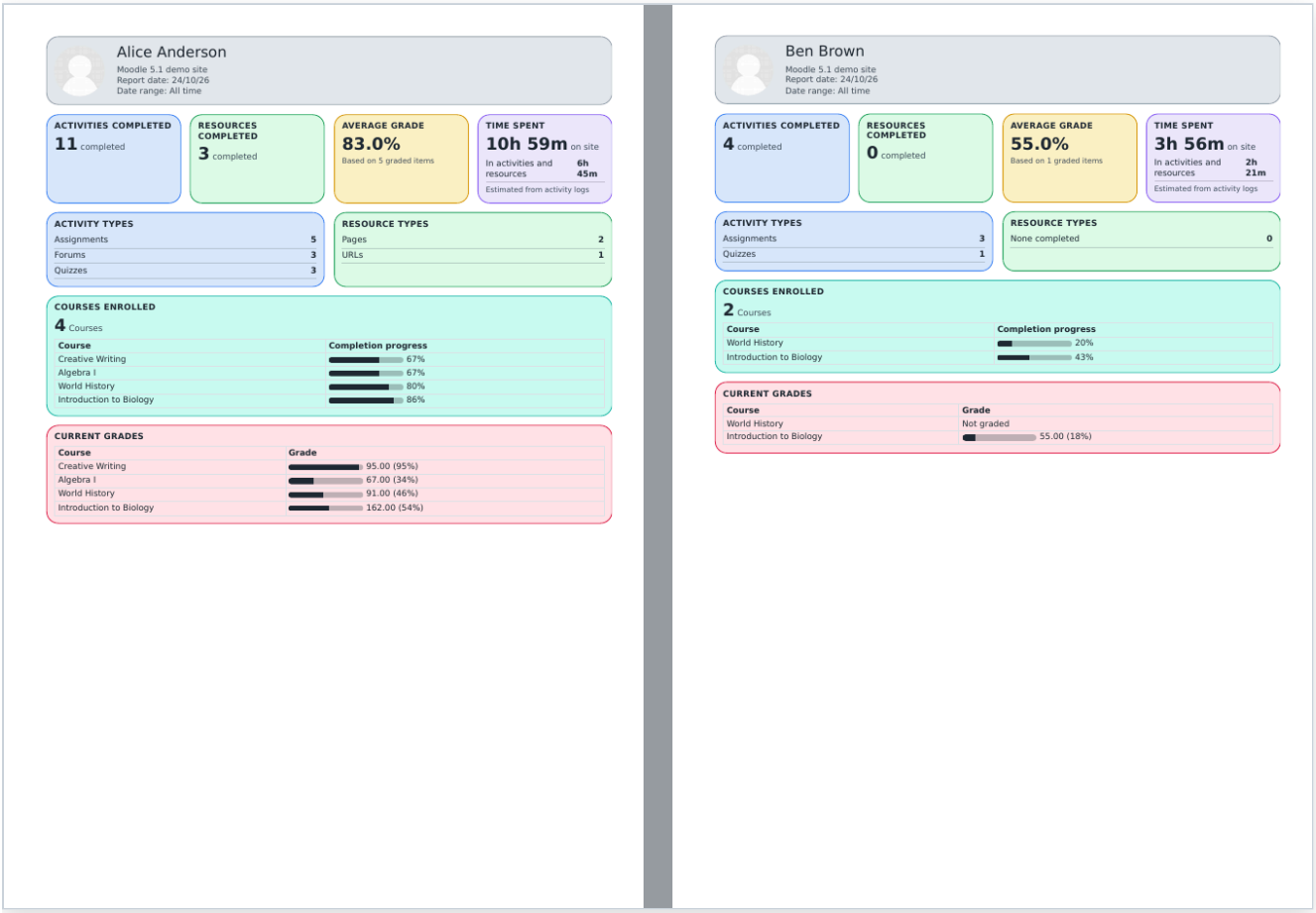
`/report/studentsummary/course.php?id=2`



26 Printing the whole class (0.4.0)

Real print output (Chrome print engine, A4, backgrounds on) for the page above with both students ticked: **2 pages, one student per page**, in colour, with the toolbar, tick boxes, filter and navigation hidden, and no blank page at the end.

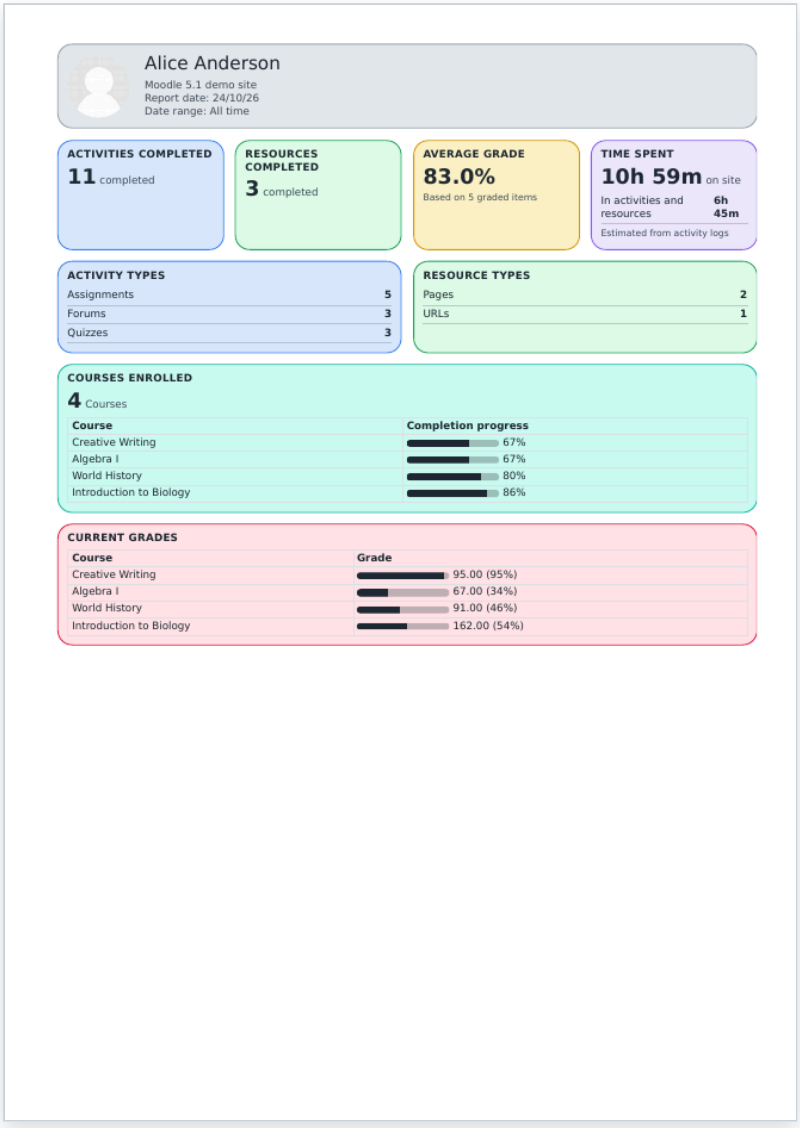
`Print selected / browser print`



27 Printing a selection (0.4.0)

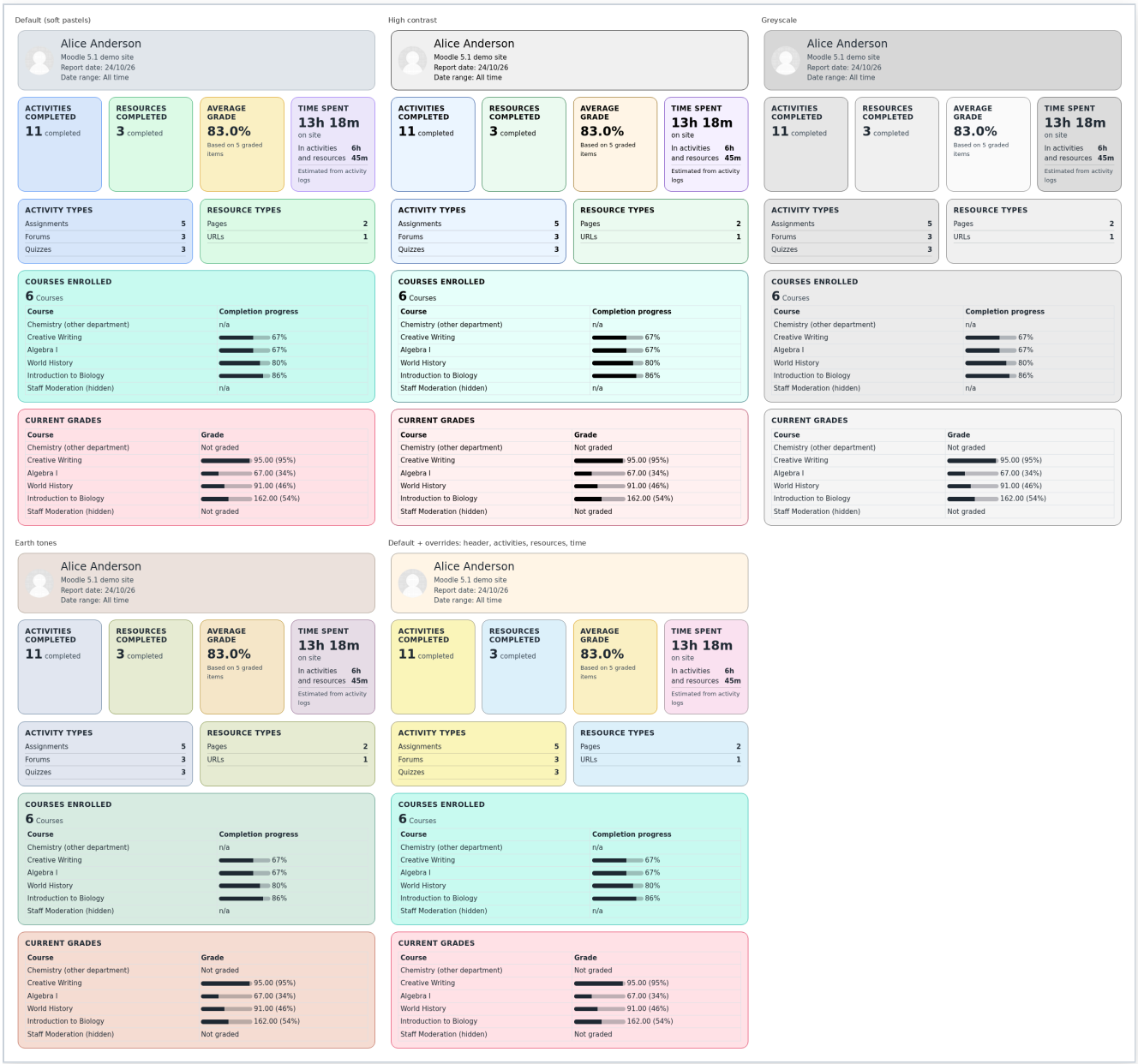
The same page with Ben un-ticked (or after pressing Print this one on Alice): the printout is **1 page** with only Alice. The selection is applied by the page itself, so any browser’s print dialog gives the same result.

`Print selected / Print this one`



All palettes side by side

Alice’s report in each ready-made palette (default, high contrast, greyscale, earth tones), and the default palette with four boxes overridden by individual colours (header, activities, resources and time). The text, headings and figures are identical in every version; only the box colours change. Captured on Moodle 5.1 as the administrator.



The printed A4 page

Printing Alice’s own report from Chrome (the **Print** button calls `window.print()`; here the print engine was driven directly with the page set to A4). The result is **1 page**, 594.96 x 841.92 pts (A4); colours are kept, and the navigation bar, filter form and Print button are hidden. This image is that real print output, rasterised.



Alice Anderson

Moodle 5.1 demo site
Report date: 24/10/26
Date range: All time

ACTIVITIES COMPLETED
11 completed

RESOURCES COMPLETED
3 completed

AVERAGE GRADE
80.0%
Based on 4 graded items

TIME SPENT
13h 18m on site
In activities and resources **6h 45m**
Estimated from activity logs

ACTIVITY TYPES

Assignments	5
Forums	3
Quizzes	3

RESOURCE TYPES

Pages	2
URLs	1

COURSES ENROLLED
5 Courses

Course	Completion progress
Chemistry (other department)	n/a
Creative Writing	67%
Algebra I	67%
World History	80%
Introduction to Biology	86%

CURRENT GRADES

Course	Grade
Chemistry (other department)	Not graded
Creative Writing	Hidden
Algebra I	67.00 (34%)
World History	91.00 (46%)
Introduction to Biology	162.00 (54%)

Summary

What this walk-through shows

- **Install:** the plugin installs on a fresh Moodle 5.1 site from the `public/report/` folder; settings and capabilities are registered.
- **Settings:** the maximum-courses setting rejects anything outside 1 to 50.
- **Colours:** the administrator picks a palette and can override any box; colours that make the text hard to read are refused, and the printed page keeps them.
- **Entry points:** Site administration > Reports, the Reports section of a user's profile (only shown to permitted viewers) and, new in 0.4.0, the course Reports page.
- **Release 0.4.1:** hardening of the course page: it reads only the user columns it needs (no password hash). Nothing visible changes.
- **Whole class (0.4.0):** a teacher sees one summary per active student of a course, ticks who to print, and prints one student per A4 page. Each student is subject to the same access rules as a single report.
- **Content:** seven colour-coded boxes on one A4 page, each with a text heading so colour is never the only cue.
- **Scoping:** the teacher sees four of Alice's six courses, a smaller time total (10h 59m against 13h 18m), and is refused for a student outside their courses.
- **Students:** may only see their own report. A course with the gradebook hidden shows "Hidden" and is left out of the average.
- **Edge cases:** no courses ("+2 more"), date filter, print layout.

Reading the numbers

- **Average grade** is the unweighted mean of individual graded activities (Alice: 88, 74, 91, 67, 95 = 83.0%; 80.0% for Alice herself because the Writing item is hidden from her).
- **Current grades** show each course total as the gradebook stores it; courses that sum several items (for example 162.00 out of 300) show a percentage of the total range.
- **Time spent** is estimated from the standard log: gaps up to the idle timeout (20 minutes) count in full, longer gaps and the last click count the tail time (60 seconds). The result is cached for 10 minutes per viewer session, so it can lag very recent activity.

Quality checks on release 0.4.1

Check	Moodle 4.5.15	Moodle 5.1.8+
phplint, phpmd, phpcs (0 warnings), validate	not re-run (0.3.0: pass)	**pass**
phpdoc	not run on 4.5	**pass (run on 0.4.0)**
PHPUnit (56 tests, 350 assertions, `--fail-on-warning`)	**pass (2 risky: core PHP 8.4 deprecation output)**	**pass**
Behat (19 scenarios, 140 steps, including one JavaScript scenario)	**pass**	**pass**
Print to A4 (headless Chrome)	not re-run (0.3.0: 1 page)	**single report 1 page; course page 1 page per student**

Known limitations

- Time spent is an estimate and depends on the standard log store and its retention.
- Completion counts need activity completion enabled in each course.
- The time estimate scans the user's log rows on a cache miss; the cache is per session and lasts 10 minutes.
- Colours are applied as inline styles. A very strict Content-Security-Policy that blocks them would show the default colours.
- Firefox printing of the course page, the interactive print-preview dialog, right-to-left languages and printing the new palettes on a black-and-white printer were not checked.

Plugin release 0.4.1 on Moodle 5.1.8+. Demo data (users, courses, grades, log entries) was generated for this document and is not real student data.